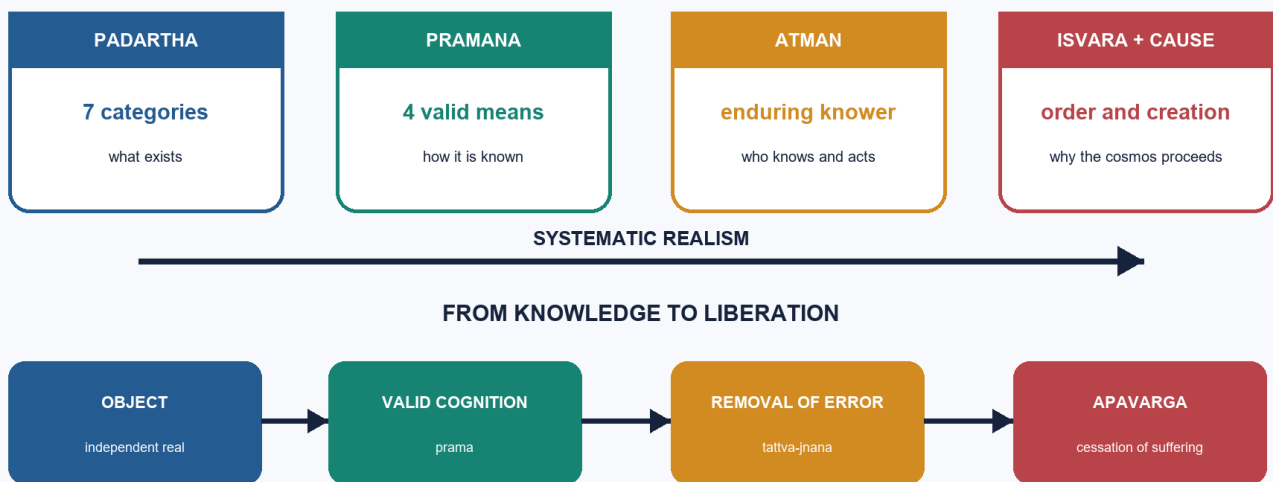


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

NYAYA-VAISESIKA - Syllabus Item 15 (Paper I - Section B)

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

NYAYA-VAISESIKA: REALITY, KNOWLEDGE, ORDER



Causation: asatkaryavada | Relations: samavaya vs samyoga | Creation: eternal atoms under moral order

Original study visual; the diagram organizes the system and does not replace doctrinal distinctions.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

NYAYA-VAISESIKA - Syllabus Item 15 (Paper I - Section B)

Syllabus (verbatim): Nyaya—Vaishesika : Theory of Categories; Theory of Appearance; Theory of Pramana; Self, Liberation; God; Proofs for the Existence of God; Theory of Causation; Atomistic Theory of Creation. **Evidence key:** FACT: canonical doctrine · ANALYSIS: analytical synthesis (for exam use) · □ contested/uncertain **Placement:** This is the heaviest-scoring realist school in Paper I Indian philosophy. It is repeatedly used to test ontology, logic, error-theory, self, liberation, theism, causation and atomism.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

NYAYA = pramāṇa-sūtra, logic, debate, proof, validity

VAIŚEṢIKA = padārtha ontology, realism, atomism

■ later convergence → Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika synthesis → Navya-Nyāya refinement

CORE AXES

Padārtha → what exists

Pramāṇa → how it is known

Khyāti → how error occurs

Ātman → enduring self, consciousness as quality

Apavarga → cessation of suffering

Īśvara → efficient cause, moral governor

Asatkāryavāda → effect is a new beginning

Atomism → world built from eternal atoms under God's direction

ANALYSIS: Exam key: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is best mastered as a system: padārtha gives ontology, pramāṇa gives epistemology, anyathākhyāti handles error, ātman secures continuity, God secures cosmic and moral order, and asatkāryavāda plus atomism explain production.

1. INTRODUCTION — TWO ALLIED SCHOOLS

1.1 Nyāya

- FACT: **Nyāya** is the school of logic, epistemology and critical debate, classically associated with **Gautama's Nyāya-sūtra**.
- FACT: Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

1.2 Vaiśeṣika

- FACT: **Vaiśeṣika**, associated with **Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika-sūtra**, is primarily an ontological school.
- FACT: It classifies reality into **padārthas** and develops atomism.

1.3 Their convergence

- FACT: Over time the two schools converge into a synthetic **Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika** system.
- FACT: Later **Navya-Nyāya**, especially through **Gaṅgeśa**, sharpens the analytic and technical vocabulary of the tradition.
- ANALYSIS: In UPSC, it is usually best to treat them together while still noting where a point is distinctly Nyāya (e.g. pramāṇa, anyathākhyāti) or distinctly Vaiśeṣika (e.g. padārtha, atomism).

2. THEORY OF CATEGORIES (PADĀRTHA)

2.1 Statement

- FACT: **Padārtha** means what is nameable and knowable.
- FACT: Classical Vaiśeṣika finally recognizes **seven padārthas**.
- □ Historically, Kaṇāda's older list is often taken as six, with **abhāva** added later. UPSC answers should note this when relevant.

2.2 The seven padārthas at a glance

Padārtha	Basic sense	Why it matters
dravya	substance	locus of qualities and actions
guṇa	quality	cannot exist independently of substance
karma	motion/action	produces conjunction and disjunction
sāmānya	universal	common feature grounding classification
viśeṣa	ultimate particularity	differentiates eternal reals
samavāya	inherence	inseparable relation
abhāva	absence/non-existence	explains negation and non-being judgments

2.3 Dravya (substance)

Statement

- FACT: **Dravya** is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.
- FACT: There are **nine dravyas**:
 1. **pr̥thivī** — earth
 2. **ap** — water
 3. **tejas** — fire
 4. **vāyu** — air
 5. **ākāśa** — ether
 6. **kāla** — time
 7. **dik** — space/direction
 8. **ātman** — self
 9. **manas** — mind

Distinction

- ANALYSIS: A common trap is to forget that **ākāśa**, **kāla** and **dik** are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.

Example

- FACT: A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

2.4 Guṇa (quality)

Statement

- FACT: **Guṇa** is a dependent ontological feature that inheres in a substance but does not itself possess further qualities or actions in the same way.
- FACT: The traditional list gives **twenty-four qualities**:
 - **rūpa** (colour)
 - **rasa** (taste)
 - **gandha** (smell)
 - **sparśa** (touch)
 - **saṃkhyā** (number)
 - **parimāṇa** (magnitude)
 - **pr̥thaktva** (distinctness)
 - **saṃyoga** (conjunction)
 - **vibhāga** (disjunction)

- **paratva** (priority/remoteness)
- **aparatva** (posteriority/nearness)
- **buddhi** (cognition)
- **sukha** (pleasure)
- **duḥkha** (pain)
- **icchā** (desire)
- **dveṣa** (aversion)
- **prayatna** (effort)
- **gurutva** (heaviness)
- **dravatva** (fluidity)
- **sneha** (viscosity)
- **saṃskāra** (dispositional tendency/momentum)
- **dharma**
- **adharma**
- **śabda** (sound)

Philosophical significance

- ANALYSIS: The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as **qualities**, not as the essence of self.

2.5 Karma (motion/action)

- FACT: **Karma** here means physical motion/action, not moral karma.
- FACT: Vaiśeṣika recognizes **five kinds**:
 1. upward movement
 2. downward movement
 3. contraction
 4. expansion
 5. locomotion/general movement
- FACT: Motion is important because it generates conjunction and disjunction, central to causation.

2.6 Sāmānya (universal)

Statement

- FACT: **Sāmānya** is the real universal, one-in-many, eternal and present in multiple particulars.
- FACT: Universals may be discussed through higher and lower ordering, often expressed as **para** and **apara** distinctions.

Argument

1. FACT: We genuinely classify many individuals under one concept: "cow", "pot", "substance".
2. FACT: Mere resemblance is insufficient unless some objective commonness grounds the classification.
3. FACT: Therefore a universal must be real.

Presupposition

- ANALYSIS: The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.

Distinction

- FACT: Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist **apoha** theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.

Example

- FACT: "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

Objection

- □ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

Reply

- FACT: The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through **samavāya** (inherence).

2.7 Jāti-bādhaka: six impediments to universalhood

- FACT: **Statement**. Not every general term names a real universal (**jāti**, class-universal); where a proposed jāti is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an imposed property or limiting condition (**upādhi**, adjunct), not as a new padārtha.
- ANALYSIS: **Philosophical function**. The six **jāti-bādhakas** (obstructors of universalhood) are the school's internal discipline against a bloated ontology of universals.

Jāti-bādhaka	Rule	Exam example / payoff
FACT: vyakter abhedah	FACT: A universal cannot have only one instance, because jāti requires plurality of loci.	FACT: ākāśatva (ether-ness) is blocked if there is only one ākāśa .
FACT: tulyatvam	FACT: Two exactly co-extensive putative universals should not both be admitted.	FACT: If ghaṭatva and kalaśatva both mean pot-ness over the same class, there is no ground for two universals.
FACT: saṅkaraḥ	FACT: Two universals cannot partially overlap without either being included in the other; they must be nested or disjoint.	FACT: The standard case is bhūtatva and mūrtatva , where cross-connection would confuse the hierarchy of kinds.
FACT: anavasthā	FACT: Universalhood itself cannot be a further universal in universals, because that would demand another universal of universalhood without end.	FACT: jātitva as a jāti over jātis is blocked by infinite regress.
FACT: rūpahāniḥ	FACT: A universal is blocked where admitting it destroys the very form or function of the entity concerned.	FACT: A universal residing in viśeṣas would defeat viśeṣa's function of ultimate individuation.
FACT: asambandhaḥ	FACT: A universal must inhere in its instances by samavāya , but samavāya itself has no further samavāya to connect it with a universal.	FACT: samavāyatva cannot be admitted as a real jāti without relation-regress.

- FACT: **Buddhist objection**. Dignāga and Dharmakīrti-style **apoha** theory argues that universals are unperceived, causally inert, and cannot be wholly present in many places at once.
- FACT: **Nyāya reply**. Universals are perceived in determinate perception (**savikalpaka-pratyakṣa**) such as "this is a cow"; their presence is by **samavāya**, not by spatial containment; and apoha is circular because exclusion of non-cows presupposes a stable cow-class or at least stable exclusion-domains.
- ANALYSIS: **Exam payoff**. Jāti-bādhaka lets Nyāya answer the Buddhist charge of ontological excess: realism about universals is not indiscriminate multiplication.

2.8 Viśeṣa (particularity)

- FACT: **Statement**. **Viśeṣa** is the ultimate individuator residing only in eternal substances: the paramāṇus of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of **ākāśa**, **kāla**, **dik**, **ātman** and **manas**.
- FACT: **Function**. Two atoms of earth may be alike in all universals and ordinary qualities; without viśeṣa they would be indistinguishable and, by the identity of indiscernibles, would collapse into one.
- FACT: **School-name significance**. Viśeṣa gives the *Vaiśeṣika* school its name because the system explains plurality through irreducible particularity.

Objection: regress of differentiators

- FACT: **Objection**. If viśeṣa differentiates one atom from another, what differentiates one viśeṣa from another? A further viśeṣa would be needed, and so on without end.

- FACT: **Reply.** Viśeṣas are **svato-vyāvartaka** (self-differentiating): they distinguish both their loci and themselves by their own nature.
- ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** Critics argue that "self-differentiating" names the stopping point rather than proving it; viśeṣa is a stipulated terminus of individuation.

Objection: imperceptible ontological IOU

- FACT: **Objection.** Viśeṣa is imperceptible and appears to be posited solely to do the explanatory job of individuating exactly similar eternal.
- FACT: **Reply.** Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika frames the posit inferentially: plurality of exactly similar eternal substances is otherwise inexplicable, and Nyāya reduces **arthāpatti** (postulation) to inference rather than making it a separate pramāṇa.
- ANALYSIS: **Comparative note.** Jaina, Buddhist and Advaita critiques often target viśeṣa and samavāya as the weakest joints of the system; Śrīharṣa's *Khaṇḍanakhaṇḍakhādyā* attacks Nyāya definitions systematically.

2.9 Samavāya (inherence)

- FACT: **Statement. Samavāya** is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred inseparable relation (**ayutasiddha-sambandha**) that holds where relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode.
- FACT: **Scope.** It holds between five standard pairs: part-whole, substance-quality, substance-motion, universal-particular, and eternal substance-its viśeṣa.
- ANALYSIS: **All-pervading sense.** Later exposition calls samavāya one and not locally multiplied; "all-pervading" should be read as one relation operating wherever the required relata obtain, not as a tenth spatial substance.

Distinction from saṃyoga

Relation	Status	Relata	Production/destruction	Example
FACT: samavāya	FACT: Inseparable relation	FACT: Ayutasiddha relata	FACT: Eternal as a relation	FACT: Colour in cloth; whole in parts
FACT: saṃyoga	FACT: A guṇa (quality)	FACT: Separable relata	FACT: Produced and destructible	FACT: Book on table; two pots in contact

- FACT: **Ayutasiddhatva issue.** Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but ANALYSIS: not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.

Objection: relation-regress

- FACT: **Objection.** If samavāya relates A and B, a further relation seems needed to relate samavāya to A and to B, generating **anavasthā** (infinite regress).
- FACT: **Reply.** Samavāya is **svarūpa-sambandha** (self-linking relation): it relates by its own nature and needs no further relator.
- ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** This is a stipulated terminus; every relational ontology must stop somewhere, and critics such as Buddhists and Śrīharṣa press the charge that Nyāya stops regress here while using regress against opponents.
- ANALYSIS: **Controlled comparison flag.** The issue resembles Bradley's regress in Western metaphysics, but that comparison belongs only after the Indian argument is complete.

Objection: one or many samavāyas?

- FACT: **Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika position.** Samavāya is one and eternal; parsimony is the Vaiśeṣika reason for not multiplying inherence-relations.
- ANALYSIS: **Internal difficulty.** If samavāya is one, it is hard to explain why it relates this quality to this substance rather than to all substances.
- ANALYSIS: **Reply.** The relata themselves determine the relation's operation: samavāya is not a free-floating glue but the inseparable tie manifest only where the relevant terms exist.

2.10 Abhāva (non-existence)

Statement

- FACT: **Abhāva** is the category of absence or non-existence.
- FACT: Four kinds are recognized:
 1. **prāgabhāva** — prior non-existence
 2. **pradhvaṃsābhāva** — posterior non-existence/destruction
 3. **atyantābhāva** — absolute non-existence
 4. **anyonyābhāva** — mutual non-existence/difference

Four kinds explained

(a) Prāgabhāva

- FACT: The non-existence of an effect before its production.
- FACT: It has no beginning, but ends when the effect is produced.

(b) Pradhvaṃsābhāva

- FACT: The non-existence of a thing after its destruction.
- FACT: It begins with destruction and has no end.

(c) Atyantābhāva

- FACT: Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.
- FACT: Standard example: a hare's horn.

(d) Anyonyābhāva

- FACT: Mutual non-existence or reciprocal difference.
- FACT: "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

2024 distinction: air does not have heat vs air is not fire

- FACT: "Air does not have heat" is best treated as **atyantābhāva** with respect to heat in air.
- FACT: "Air is not fire" is **anyonyābhāva**, because it expresses difference between two entities.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore they are not the same kind of absence.

2023 issue: counterpositive (pratiyogin)

- FACT: Every absence is the absence **of** something; that absent positive term is the **pratiyogin** or counterpositive.
- ANALYSIS: This shows abhāva is not sheer blankness; it has structured intentional content.

3. THEORY OF PRAMĀṆA

3.1 The four pramāṇas

- FACT: Nyāya recognizes four pramāṇas:
 1. **pratyakṣa** — perception
 2. **anumāna** — inference
 3. **upamāna** — comparison/analogy
 4. **śabda** — testimony

3.2 Pratyakṣa (perception)

Gautama's definition (2025)

- FACT: The classical Nyāya definition states in substance: "**indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannam jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam**".
- FACT: UPSC expects clause-by-clause unpacking.

Clause-by-clause analysis

1. **indriyārtha-sannikarṣa** — sense-object contact

- FACT: Perception begins with a relation between sense organ and object.
- ANALYSIS: This marks perception as causally immediate relative to the relevant sense relation.
- 2. **utpannam** — produced
 - FACT: The cognition must be produced from that contact.
 - ANALYSIS: This excludes merely remembered or verbally derived knowledge.
- 3. **avyapadeśyam** — non-verbal / not dependent on testimony
 - FACT: Perception is not constituted by words as words.
 - ANALYSIS: This distinguishes it from śabda.
- 4. **avyabhicāri** — non-errant
 - FACT: Genuine perception is unerring.
 - ANALYSIS: Illusion is excluded from valid perception in the final sense.
- 5. **vyavasāyātmakam** — determinate
 - FACT: It is definite, not doubtful.
 - ANALYSIS: This clause creates discussion because later Naiyāyikas also admit a prior indeterminate phase.

Nirvikalpaka and savikalpaka perception

- FACT: **Nirvikalpaka** perception is indeterminate, pre-predicative awareness.
- FACT: **Savikalpaka** perception is determinate: qualified, nameable awareness such as "this is a blue pot".
- ANALYSIS: The tradition often uses nirvikalpaka to explain how raw awareness can ground determinate judgment.

The six sannikarṣas

- FACT: Nyāya elaborates six sense-object relations:
- 1. **saṃyoga** — conjunction
- 2. **saṃyukta-samavāya** — inherence in what is conjoined
- 3. **saṃyukta-samaveta-samavāya** — inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined
- 4. **samavāya** — inherence
- 5. **samaveta-samavāya** — inherence in what inheres
- 6. **viśeṣaṇa-viśeṣya-bhāva** — qualifier-qualified relation
- ANALYSIS: These are technical tools for explaining how the senses can apprehend not just substances, but also qualities, universals and absences.

Extraordinary perception (alaukika) (2023, 2019)

1. FACT: **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**
 - perception through the universal; by apprehending a universal one can perceptually relate to all its instances in a distinctive way.
 - ANALYSIS: This supports Nyāya realism about universals: universals are perceived, not merely inferred.
2. FACT: **Jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**
 - a case where prior cognition mediates present perception; e.g. one may in a derivative sense "see" sandalwood as fragrant.
 - ANALYSIS: This becomes crucial in Nyāya's theory of error.
3. FACT: **Yogaja-pratyakṣa**
 - yogic perception of subtle, distant, past or future objects.

3.3 Anumāna (inference)

Statement

- FACT: **Anumāna** is knowledge arising through a sign (**liṅga/hetu**, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (**sādhya**).

Five members of inference

Using the hill-fire example:

1. FACT: **pratijñā** — The hill has fire.
 2. FACT: **hetu** — because it has smoke.
 3. FACT: **udāharaṇa** — wherever there is smoke, there is fire, as in a kitchen.
 4. FACT: **upanaya** — this hill has smoke of that kind.
 5. FACT: **nigamana** — therefore the hill has fire.
- FACT: **Purpose**. The **pañcāvayava** (five-membered syllogism) is the form of proof for another (**parārthānumāna**); it makes explicit the vyāpti and the application to the pakṣa.

Five characteristics of a valid hetu

1. FACT: **pakṣadharmatā** — the hetu is present in the subject under consideration.
 2. FACT: **sapakṣa-sattva** — the hetu is present in similar positive instances.
 3. FACT: **vipakṣa-asattva** — the hetu is absent in dissimilar negative instances.
 4. FACT: **abādhita** — the sādhyā is not contradicted by stronger knowledge.
 5. FACT: **asatpratipakṣa** — the hetu is not opposed by an equally strong counter-reason.
- ANALYSIS: **Exam link**. These five marks are the positive side of the same test that appears negatively as **hetvābhāsa** (fallacy of the probans) in §3.4.

3.4 Vyāpti-grahaṇa: grasping invariable concomitance

- FACT: **Statement**. **Vyāpti-grahaṇa** is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.

1. Vyāpti defined

- FACT: **Definition**. **Vyāpti** is invariable, unconditional concomitance (**avinābhāva-niyama**) between the **hetu/linga** (probans, e.g. smoke) and the **sādhyā** (probandum, e.g. fire).
- FACT: **Distinction**. **Samavyāpti** is equal extension or convertibility: two terms pervade each other.
- FACT: **Distinction**. **Viśamavyāpti / asamavyāpti** is unequal extension: all smoke is pervaded by fire, but not all fire is pervaded by smoke.
- FACT: **Condition**. Nyāya requires **niyata** (fixed) and **anaupādhika** (unconditioned by an upādhi) concomitance, not mere frequency.

2. Bhūyodarśana: repeated positive and negative observation

- FACT: **Argument**. The knower observes co-presence (**anvaya**) in many positive instances: smoke with fire in kitchens, hearths and similar cases.
- FACT: **Argument**. The knower also observes co-absence (**vyatireka**) in negative instances: where fire is absent, smoke is absent.
- ANALYSIS: **Limit**. Bhūyodarśana alone is not sufficient, because repeated observation remains a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal.

3. Vyabhicāra-adarśana: absence of counter-instance

- FACT: **Argument**. The investigator searches for deviation (**vyabhicāra**) and does not find a case where the hetu occurs without the sādhyā.
- ANALYSIS: **Limit**. This strengthens the universal but still needs the removal of hidden conditions.

4. Upādhi-nirāsa: removal of conditioning adjunct

- FACT: **Definition**. **Upādhi** is a conditioning adjunct: **sādhyā-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakaḥ** — that which pervades the sādhyā but does not pervade the hetu.
- FACT: **Example**. In the bad inference "the hill has smoke because it has fire", **wet fuel (ārdra-indhana)** is the upādhi: wherever there is smoke there is wet fuel, but not wherever there is fire is there wet fuel.
- FACT: **Argument**. Therefore fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke; the fire-to-smoke inference is conditional and fails.

- FACT: **Nyāya reply to Cārvāka.** The Cārvāka says a hidden condition may always lurk; Nyāya replies that systematic **upādhi-nirāsa** and **upādhi-śaṅkā-nivṛtti** (removal of the suspicion of an adjunct), supported by tarka, converts observation into warranted universal cognition.

5. Tarka: reductive doubt-removal

- FACT: **Statement.** Tarka is hypothetical or counterfactual reasoning that removes residual doubt by showing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition.
- FACT: **Example.** If smoke were not pervaded by fire, smoke could occur without fire; this contradicts uniform experience and would make the causal order unintelligible.
- FACT: **Status.** Tarka is **pramāṇa-anugrahaka** (an aid to pramāṇas), not an independent pramāṇa; it supports perception and inference by eliminating the rival supposition.
- ANALYSIS: **Forms.** Common exam-ready forms of unacceptable consequence include **ātmāśraya** (self-dependence), **anyonyāśraya** (mutual dependence), **cakraka** (circularity), **anavasthā** (infinite regress), and contradiction of perception or inference (**pratyakṣa/anumāna-virodha**).

6. Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa: universal-mediated perception

- FACT: **Cross-reference.** As noted in §3.2, **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** is extraordinary (**alaukika**) perception through the universal.
- FACT: **Role in vyāpti.** On perceiving an instance of smokeness, the cognizer is perceptually related to smoke as a universal, so all smoke as such can be presented without an infinite survey of every smoke-instance.
- ANALYSIS: **Induction payoff.** This is the specifically Nyāya move against the problem of induction: because **jāti** is real, the universal can be cognitively grasped, not merely guessed from samples.

7. Pakṣadharmatā and parāmarśa

- FACT: **Pakṣadharmatā.** The hetu must be known to exist in the pakṣa: this hill has smoke.
- FACT: **Parāmarśa.** The immediate cause (**karaṇa**) of inferential cognition is the subsumptive reflection: "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".
- FACT: **Connection to pañcāvayava.** The five-membered syllogism makes parāmarśa communicable: pratijñā states the thesis, hetu states the sign, udāharaṇa states vyāpti with example, upanaya applies it to the pakṣa, and nigamana states the conclusion.

8. Hetvābhāsa as the negative test of vyāpti

Hetvābhāsa	What fails	Subtypes / examples
FACT: savyabhicāra / anaikāntika (irregular)	FACT: The hetu is not invariably tied to the sādhyā.	FACT: sādhāraṇa occurs in both sapakṣa and vipakṣa; asādhāraṇa is confined to the pakṣa; anupasaṃhārin is too wide to allow contrast.
FACT: viruddha (contradictory)	FACT: The hetu proves the opposite of the intended sādhyā.	FACT: A reason meant to prove permanence instead proves impermanence.
FACT: satpratipakṣa / prakaraṇasama (counterbalanced)	FACT: An equally strong counter-hetu proves the contrary.	FACT: The debate remains balanced because each side has a reason of comparable force.
FACT: asiddha / sādhyasama (unproved)	FACT: The hetu itself is not established.	FACT: āśrayāsiddha : the pakṣa-locus is unreal; svarūpāsiddha : the hetu is absent in the pakṣa; vyāpyatvāsiddha : pervasion is unproved, often due to upādhi.
FACT: bādhita / kālātīta (stultified)	FACT: The conclusion is contradicted by a stronger pramāṇa.	FACT: Fire cannot be inferred as cold because perception defeats the sādhyā.

- ANALYSIS: **Linking rule.** Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.

Objection: Cārvāka and the Humean parallel

- FACT: **Objection.** No finite observation licenses a universal; upādhi-elimination can never be completed; tarka presupposes inference and is circular; and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa looks like an ad hoc posit.
- ANALYSIS: **Humean parallel.** The parallel is that observed regularity alone does not logically entail future or universal necessity.

Reply: Nyāya answer

- FACT: **Reply.** The demand for mathematical certainty from empirical universals is misplaced; Nyāya claims warranted cognition, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.
- FACT: **Reply.** Tarka is not an independent proof of vyāpti, so it does not circularly infer what it must prove; it removes the contrary supposition so that perception and inference can function.
- FACT: **Reply.** Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa is not ad hoc within Nyāya ontology, because universals are real padārthas and can be presented in cognition.
- FACT: **Reply.** The sceptic's denial of all inference is itself a universal claim about inference and so invites **svavacana-virodha** (self-contradiction in one's own speech).
- ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** The Nyāya answer is strongest if one accepts realism about universals; if jāti is denied, the induction solution becomes contested.

3.5 Upamāna (comparison)

- FACT: **Upamāna** gives knowledge of the relation between a word and its referent through resemblance.
- FACT: If one is told that a **gavaya** resembles a cow, later encountering such an animal yields knowledge that this is what the word denotes.
- ANALYSIS: The point is semantic acquisition via similarity.

3.6 Śabda (testimony)

Statement

- FACT: **Śabda** is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as **āptavākya**, the statement of an **āpta** — a trustworthy competent person.

Argument

1. FACT: Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.
2. FACT: Human life depends on reliable communication.
3. FACT: Therefore testimony must be recognized as an independent pramāṇa when it comes from a trustworthy source.

Vedic testimony

- FACT: Nyāya accepts the Veda as valid testimony.
- FACT: In later Nyāya, its authority is often connected with God as omniscient author.

3.7 Why memory (smṛti) is not a pramāṇa (2024)

- FACT: Memory reproduces a past cognition; it does not generate **novel** knowledge.
- FACT: A pramāṇa must produce fresh, true cognition of what is not already known in that mode.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore memory may be psychologically useful but is not epistemically pramāṇa in the technical sense.

3.8 Svataḥ and parataḥ prāmāṇya (2025)

- FACT: Nyāya defends **parataḥ-prāmāṇya** and **parataḥ-aprāmāṇya**.
- FACT: That means both validity and invalidity of cognition are known through external conditions or later confirmation/disconfirmation.
- ANALYSIS: This is a standard UPSC trap: Nyāya is not merely parataḥ for invalidity; it is parataḥ for both.
- FACT: Contrast: Mīmāṃsā generally takes validity to be self-manifest (**svataḥ**) while invalidity is known later.

3.9 Naiyāyika-Buddhist debate on pramāṇa and pramāṇaphala (2025)

- FACT: **Nyāya**: pramāṇa and **pramāṇa-phala** / **pramiti** are different. The pramāṇa is the instrument or means; the resulting true cognition is its fruit.
- FACT: **Buddhist epistemologists** such as Dignāga are commonly read as tightening the relation so that cognition itself is both revelatory act and result in a self-luminous framework.
- ANALYSIS: The contrast turns on broader metaphysics: Nyāya is instrumentally realist; Buddhist epistemology is more cognition-centred.

4. THEORY OF APPEARANCE (KHYĀTIVĀDA)

4.1 Anyathākhyāti stated precisely

- FACT: Nyāya explains illusion through **anyathākhyāti**.
- FACT: In the classic shell-silver case, both the presented "this" and silver are real; the error lies in taking silver, which exists elsewhere, as here.
- ANALYSIS: Error is therefore misplacement or wrong synthesis, not apprehension of a non-entity.

4.2 Mechanism

1. FACT: A present perceptual base exists — e.g. shell.
2. FACT: A past impression of silver is activated.
3. FACT: Through **jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, the silver becomes present to consciousness in a derivative extraordinary perceptual way.
4. FACT: Due to non-discrimination, the mind synthesizes the present locus and remembered object wrongly.
5. FACT: The erroneous cognition "this is silver" results.

4.3 Presupposition

- ANALYSIS: Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

4.4 Distinction from rival khyātivādas

Theory	School	Error explained as
anyathākhyāti	Nyāya	real object known elsewhere, mislocated here
ātmakhyāti	Yogācāra	internal cognition projected outward
asatkhyāti	Mādhyaṃika reading in standard doxography	apprehension of the non-existent
akhyāti	Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	failure to discriminate two valid cognitions
anirvacanīya-khyāti	Advaita Vedānta	error-object neither real nor unreal

4.5 Jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa and anyathākhyāti (2019)

- FACT: Nyāya uses **jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** to explain how the silver can be experientially present without being physically present in that location.
- ANALYSIS: It bridges memory and presentative awareness while preserving realism.

4.6 Naiyāyika response to anirvacanīya-khyāti (2021)

- FACT: Nyāya objects that the Advaitin's "neither real nor unreal" status is obscure and violates classical logical alternatives.
- FACT: For Nyāya, the error-object must be explainable using real entities and cognitive misrelation; no third ontological status is needed.

5. SELF (ĀTMAN)

5.1 Statement

- FACT: The **self (ātman)** is a real enduring substance distinct from body, senses and mind.
- FACT: Consciousness is not its essence but an **adventitious quality** arising under proper conditions.

5.2 Six Nyāya arguments for the self (2024)

□ Secondary sources sometimes present the grouping slightly differently. The following six-track presentation is the standard exam-ready arrangement.

1. FACT: **From desire (icchā) and aversion (dveṣa)**
 - these states require a subject to whom they belong.
2. FACT: **From effort (prayatna)**
 - purposive striving implies an agent.
3. FACT: **From pleasure (sukha) and pain (duḥkha)**
 - experiences require an experiencer.
4. FACT: **From cognition (buddhi / jñāna)**
 - cognition is a quality and must inhere in a substance; that substance is self.
5. FACT: **From recognition and memory**
 - "I who saw before now remember" implies an enduring substrate connecting experiences.
6. FACT: **From the body-mind-sense complex as instrument**
 - an organized instrumentality suggests a user/owner distinct from the instrument.

5.3 Manas (mind)

- FACT: **Manas** is an atomic internal organ.
- FACT: It mediates between ātman and the external senses.
- FACT: Because mind is atomic, the self attends to one sense-cognition at a time.

5.4 Distinction from Advaita

- FACT: Nyāya: consciousness is a quality of self.
- FACT: Advaita: consciousness is the very nature of the self.
- ANALYSIS: This is one of the most examinable contrasts in Indian philosophy.

5.5 Objection

- □ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?

5.6 Reply

- FACT: Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.

6. LIBERATION (APAVARGA)

6.1 Statement

- FACT: **Apavarga** is absolute cessation of pain: **duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti**.
- FACT: It is not primarily a positive bliss-state in Nyāya's standard formulation.

6.2 Ladder to liberation

- FACT: The classic Nyāya chain runs:
- **tattva-jñāna** -> removal of **mithyā-jñāna** -> cessation of **doṣa** (rāga, dveṣa, moha) -> cessation of **pravṛtti** -> cessation of **janma** -> cessation of **duḥkha** -> **apavarga**

- ANALYSIS: Knowledge matters not because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes error that sustains bondage-producing activity.

6.3 Nature of the liberated self

- FACT: In mokṣa the self remains as a pure substance without pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or even ordinary cognition.
- FACT: Consciousness ceases because the required conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects ceases.

6.4 The stone-like liberation objection

- FACT: Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?

6.5 Nyāya reply

- FACT: The aim is freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss.
- ANALYSIS: Bliss may itself be relational and capable of engendering attachment; apavarga is secure because it is sheer release from all suffering-conditions.

7. GOD (ĪŚVARA)

7.1 Statement

- FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika affirms Īśvara as an eternal, omniscient, omnipotent being.
- FACT: God is the **nimitta-kāraṇa** (efficient cause), not the material cause of the world.
- FACT: The material cause remains atoms.

7.2 Nature of God

- FACT: God is often characterized as a special self never bound by karma.
- FACT: He orders atoms at creation, dispenses karmic fruits, and in later Nyāya authors the Veda.

7.3 Distinction

- ANALYSIS: Nyāya God is not Advaita's non-dual Brahman and not Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity. He is a real personal-intelligent governor within a pluralist realist metaphysics.

8. PROOFS FOR THE EXISTENCE OF GOD

8.1 Udayana's project

- FACT: **Udayana**, especially in *Nyāyakusumāñjali*, develops systematic arguments for God.
- □ The exact naming and count vary somewhat across secondary presentations. UPSC usually expects the major four and may reward mention of the extended list.

8.2 Four major arguments (2019)

(a) Kāryāt — from effect

- FACT: The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.
- FACT: Effects require an intelligent efficient cause.
- FACT: Therefore the world requires God.
- ANALYSIS: This is Nyāya's strongest cosmological-teleological bridge.

(b) Āyojanāt — from combination/arrangement

- FACT: At the beginning of creation, atoms must first combine.
- FACT: Unintelligent atoms cannot purposively initiate ordered combination.
- FACT: Therefore an intelligent arranger is required: God.

(c) Dhṛtyādeḥ — from support/sustenance

- FACT: The order, maintenance and dissolution of the cosmos suggest sustaining intelligence.
- ANALYSIS: This moves from bare origination to continuing governance.

(d) Śruteḥ — from scripture

- FACT: The Veda is authoritative knowledge.
- FACT: Such authoritative revelation implies an omniscient source.
- FACT: Therefore God.

8.3 Additional arguments often cited

5. FACT: **Padāt** — from words / linguistic convention
6. FACT: **Pratyayataḥ** — from cognition/authoritative knowledge structure
7. FACT: **Vākyāt** — from meaningful sentences, especially Vedic sentences
8. FACT: **Saṅkhyāviśeṣāt** — from determinate numerical modes of atomic combination

8.4 Presuppositions

- ANALYSIS: These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.

8.5 Objections and replies

Objection 1: Sāṃkhya

- FACT: Prakṛti can explain the world; God is unnecessary.
- FACT: Nyāya reply: unconscious prakṛti or atoms cannot account for purposive order and karmic allocation unaided.

Objection 2: Mīmāṃsā

- FACT: The Veda is authorless; scriptural authority does not imply God.
- FACT: Nyāya reply: intelligible authoritative sentences point better to omniscient authorship.

Objection 3: Problem of evil

- FACT: If God is omnipotent and benevolent, why suffering?
- FACT: Nyāya reply: karmic order distributes fruits; God is dispenser, not arbitrary tyrant.

8.6 Udayana's cumulative structure: not one isolated proof

- FACT: **Statement.** Udayana's *Nyāyakusumāñjali* is best read as a reply to successive objections, not as one solitary proof mechanically added to Nyāya metaphysics.
- FACT: **Structure.** The work removes obstacles to theism step by step: that there is no unseen cause, that an unseen cause needs no intelligent controller, that Vedic authority can stand without an author, and that karma or atoms can function without governance.
- ANALYSIS: **20-mark payoff.** A strong answer presents Udayana's proofs as a converging or cumulative-case argument: each strand alone can be challenged, but together they are said to converge on one explanatory hypothesis.

The explanatory hypothesis

- FACT: **Thesis.** Īśvara is an omniscient, eternal, bodiless agent who is the efficient (**nimitta**) but not material cause of the world.
- FACT: **Cosmic role.** Īśvara conjoins atoms at the beginning of a creative cycle through volition operating with the **adr̥ṣṭa** of souls.
- FACT: **Moral role.** Īśvara dispenses karmic fruits because unconscious adr̥ṣṭa cannot intelligently allot results by itself.
- FACT: **Scriptural role.** Īśvara is the **āpta** (trustworthy authority) author or source of the Veda in later Nyāya theism.

Inferential forms of the main proofs

Proof	Pakṣa	Hetu	Sādhya	Drṣṭānta
FACT: kāryāt (from effect)	FACT: The world	FACT: It is an effect, composite and ordered.	FACT: It has an intelligent maker.	FACT: Pot and potter.
FACT: āyojanāt (from combination)	FACT: Primordial atomic conjunction	FACT: Unconscious atoms and unconscious adṛṣṭa cannot initiate ordered first motion.	FACT: It requires an intelligent impeller.	FACT: Ordered arrangement produced by an agent.
FACT: dhṛtyādeḥ (from support/sustenance and destruction)	FACT: The ordered cosmos	FACT: It is sustained, regulated and dissolved.	FACT: It requires governing intelligence.	FACT: A maintained artefact or polity requires a regulator.
FACT: padāt / śruteḥ / vākyāt (from words, Veda and sentences)	FACT: Vedic and meaningful sentences	FACT: Sentences require competent authorship, and Vedic scope exceeds ordinary knowledge.	FACT: The Veda has an omniscient source.	FACT: Ordinary meaningful instruction from a competent speaker.
ANALYSIS: adṛṣṭa/karma-administration argument	FACT: Karmic distribution	FACT: Unconscious adṛṣṭa cannot allot fruits with moral precision.	FACT: An intelligent administrator is required.	FACT: A just allocation system requires a conscious allocator.

- ☐ **Count caution.** The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

Objections and replies

Opponent	Objection	Nyāya reply	Residual force
FACT: Mīmāṃsā / Kumārila	FACT: The Veda is authorless, and apūrva can link ritual action to fruit without God.	FACT: Meaningful authoritative sentences and moral dispensation are better explained by an omniscient āpta; unconscious apūrva cannot administer fruits.	ANALYSIS: If Vedic authorlessness is accepted, the śruteḥ proof loses force.
FACT: Sāṃkhya	FACT: Prakṛti's own teleology explains the world, and a perfect God has no motive to create.	FACT: Unconscious prakṛti cannot purposively allocate karma or initiate ordered atomic motion; God's action follows souls' adṛṣṭa, not desire-based lack.	ANALYSIS: The motive problem remains if divine action is modelled too anthropomorphically.
FACT: Buddhist / Dharmakīrti and Śāntarakṣita-style critique	FACT: The world is not observed as an effect in the relevant sense, and the pot–potter analogy fails (vaiṣamya) because a potter has a body, hands and external material.	FACT: Nyāya treats composite, ordered, dependent wholes as inferable effects and allows a bodiless omniscient agent because embodiment is not essential to agency.	ANALYSIS: The analogy is strained because worldly makers are always embodied.
FACT: Cārvāka	FACT: God is never perceived, and inference itself is unreliable.	FACT: Nyāya first defends vyāpti and inference; once anumāna is secured, imperceptibility alone does not disprove a cause.	ANALYSIS: The proof works only for someone who grants Nyāya pramāṇa theory.
FACT: Advaita	FACT: Īśvara is real only at the vyāvahārika level, not ultimately non-dual reality.	FACT: Nyāya rejects the two-level downgrade and insists on plural realist ontology.	ANALYSIS: The disagreement is rooted in incompatible metaphysical starting-points.
FACT: Problem of evil	FACT: If God is good and omnipotent, why is there suffering?	FACT: God dispenses fruits according to beginningless karma; evil is traceable to souls' karma, not divine arbitrariness.	ANALYSIS: This saves goodness at the cost of independence, because God appears constrained by karma he did not create.

9. THEORY OF CAUSATION

9.1 Asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda

Statement

- FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika defends **asatkāryavāda**, also called **ārambhavāda**.
- FACT: The effect does **not** pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

Argument

1. FACT: Before production, the effect is absent.
2. FACT: If it already existed fully in the cause, production would be meaningless.
3. FACT: Production therefore brings forth a new entity.
4. FACT: Cloth is not simply threads under another description; it is a new whole produced from them.

Presupposition

- ANALYSIS: The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.

Distinction

- FACT: Contrast **Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda**, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

9.2 Three kinds of cause

1. FACT: **Samavāyī-kāraṇa** — inherent/material cause
 - e.g. threads for cloth.
2. FACT: **Asamavāyī-kāraṇa** — non-inherent cause
 - e.g. qualities or conjunctions in the material cause that help produce the effect.
3. FACT: **Nimitta-kāraṇa** — efficient cause
 - e.g. the weaver.

9.3 Seed and tree (2021)

- FACT: Asked whether the seed contains the tree, Nyāya says **no** in the satkāryavāda sense.
- FACT: The tree is a new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions.
- ANALYSIS: So the seed is causal ground, not a concealed miniature tree in metaphysical latency.

9.4 Prāgabhāva against Sāṃkhya (2023)

- FACT: Before the effect arises, it has **prāgabhāva** — prior non-existence.
- FACT: This prior absence shows the effect is genuinely absent before production.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore prāgabhāva becomes a sharp weapon against satkāryavāda.

10. ATOMISTIC THEORY OF CREATION

10.1 Paramāṇu

- FACT: The basic physical unit is the **paramāṇu** — atom.
- FACT: It is eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, and often described as minute/spherical (**parimāṇḍalya**).

10.2 Why atoms must be partless and eternal

Argument

1. FACT: If every part had further parts without end, no ultimate physical unit would remain.
 2. FACT: Infinite regress would undermine stable explanation of finite compounds.
 3. FACT: Therefore atoms must be indivisible.
- ANALYSIS: Traditional absurdity arguments compare tiny and huge objects: if division had no ultimate stop, a mustard seed and a mountain would become equally analyzable without foundation.

10.3 Combination sequence

- FACT: Atoms combine into **dvyaṇuka** (dyads).
- FACT: Dyads combine into larger units such as **tryaṇuka** / **trasareṇu**, marking the threshold toward perceptibility in standard textbook exposition.
- FACT: Gross objects arise from increasingly complex combinations.

10.4 Initiation of motion

- FACT: At dissolution, atoms remain but compounds break apart.
- FACT: At creation, first motion must begin again.
- FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika often invokes **adr̥ṣṭa** (unseen moral force) and the will of God as the initiator of this first motion.

10.5 Cycles of creation and dissolution

- FACT: Creation (**sr̥ṣṭi**) and dissolution (**pralaya**) occur cyclically.
- FACT: God wills; atoms combine; the world appears.
- FACT: God wills or cosmic conditions reverse; compounds disintegrate; dissolution occurs.
- FACT: Atoms persist through pralaya.

11. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

Axis	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Rival contrast
Universals	real sāmānya	Buddhist apoha / nominalist tendency
Error	anyathākhyāti	Advaita anirvacanīya-khyāti; Prābhākara akhyāti
Validity	parataḥ for truth and falsity	Mīmāṃsā svataḥ for validity
Self	enduring substance; consciousness quality	Buddhism no-self; Advaita self as consciousness
Liberation	cessation of pain, not bliss	Vedānta blissful mokṣa
Causation	asatkāryavāda	Sāṃkhya satkāryavāda
God	efficient creator and governor	Buddhism/Mīmāṃsā/Sāṃkhya critiques

11.1 Words signify universals or particulars? (2023)

- FACT: Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects through universals and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.
- FACT: Mīmāṃsā develops a different semantic sensitivity, often giving stronger independent weight to word-meaning relations in sentence-use.
- ANALYSIS: In UPSC, answer by showing Nyāya's realist semantics: universals are objective and hence linguistically significant.

11.2 Naiyāyika response to Cārvāka objections against anumāna (2022)

- FACT: Cārvāka attacks inference by doubting universal relation.
- FACT: Nyāya replies that ordinary and scientific life depend on reliable inferential regularities established through observation, elimination of upādhi, and tarka.
- ANALYSIS: The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice.

12. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

12.1 Against universals

- FACT: Buddhist objection: universals are unnecessary; exclusion explains classification.
- FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply: exclusion presupposes stable classes; real commonness is required.

12.2 Against samavāya

- FACT: Objection: inherence multiplies entities unnecessarily.
- FACT: Reply: without a distinct inseparable relation, whole-part and quality-substance relations remain unexplained.

12.3 Against stone-like mokṣa

- FACT: Objection: desire for unconscious liberation is incoherent.
- FACT: Reply: complete removal of pain is a sufficient rational goal.

12.4 Against God proofs

- FACT: Objection: order can be explained without God.
- FACT: Reply: Nyāya insists purposive order, moral dispensation and linguistic normativity are not adequately explained by blind atoms alone.

13. COMMON UPSC TRAPS

- ANALYSIS: **Trap 1:** saying Nyāya is parataḥ-prāmāṇya only for invalidity. It is parataḥ for **both** validity and invalidity.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 2:** saying asatkāryavāda denies causation. It denies pre-existent effect, not causal production.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 3:** confusing **anyathākhyāti** with **anirvacanīya-khyāti**.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 4:** forgetting that Kaṇāda's earlier list is six categories; **abhāva** is added later as the seventh.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 5:** writing that consciousness is the essence of self in Nyāya. It is an **adventitious quality**.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 6:** treating apavarga as bliss. Standard Nyāya emphasizes cessation of pain.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 7:** listing only seven dravyas. There are **nine**.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 8:** saying "air does not have heat" and "air is not fire" are the same abhāva. They are different.
- ANALYSIS: **Trap 9:** saying universals are not perceived. Nyāya allows their perception through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**.

14. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

- FACT: **Padārtha:** knowable/nameable category.
- FACT: **Dravya:** substance, locus of guṇa and karma.
- FACT: **Sāmānya:** real universal, one in many.
- FACT: **Viśeṣa:** ultimate differentiator.
- FACT: **Samavāya:** inseparable inherence relation.
- FACT: **Abhāva:** non-existence/absence.
- FACT: **Pratyakṣa:** perceptual cognition from sense-object contact.
- FACT: **Anumāna:** inferential knowledge based on vyāpti.
- FACT: **Āptavākya:** trustworthy testimony.
- FACT: **Anyathākhyāti:** error as misplacement of a real object.
- FACT: **Parataḥ-prāmāṇya:** extrinsic ascertainment of validity.
- FACT: **Asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda:** effect is a new beginning.
- FACT: **Apavarga:** absolute cessation of suffering.
- FACT: **Paramāṇu:** eternal atom.

Quick examinable statements

- ANALYSIS: "Nyāya realism extends even to error: illusion is not contact with nothing, but misrelation among reals."
- ANALYSIS: "Vaiśeṣika multiplies categories only where explanatory need demands them."
- ANALYSIS: "Nyāya self is enduring, but consciousness in it is episodic and conditioned."
- ANALYSIS: "Asatkāryavāda protects novelty in production."

<!-- restored-2018-2020-doctrine:start -->

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Brown table and book on table: samavāya versus saṃyoga

- FACT: Brown colour inheres in the table through **samavāya**, an inseparable relation of quality and substance; the book stands on the table through **saṃyoga**, a contingent conjunction whose relata can exist separately.
- WRONG: Spatial closeness is not the criterion of inherence; ontological inseparability and the relata's category relation are decisive.

Anyathāsiddha and ananyathāsiddha

- FACT: A causal condition is **ananyathāsiddha** when its relevance to the effect is not established otherwise; an **anyathāsiddha** condition is accidental, remote or already explained through another causal factor and is excluded from the definition of cause.
- ANALYSIS: The distinction prevents over-inclusion in asatkāryavāda: not everything preceding or accompanying an effect is its cause.

Viśeṣa and comparative theism

- FACT: Viśeṣa individuates eternal atoms and selves of the same class; without it numerical plurality would collapse. Critics object to a regress of differentiators; Vaiśeṣika treats viśeṣa as self-differentiating.
- FACT: Nyāya infers an intelligent maker/orderer from effects, atomic conjunction and governance. Classical Yoga's Īśvara is a special puruṣa and an object/support of practice; it is not established by exactly the same creator inference.

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<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:start -->

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority**: Primary ownership rises to 22 of 112 parts, the largest Indian owner.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth**: The restored papers add samavāya versus saṃyoga through table examples, Buddhist/Nyāya absence-cognition, Nyāya versus Yoga proofs of God, anyathāsiddha/ananyathāsiddha and the logical/metaphysical role of viśeṣa.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence**: Do not treat every relation as inherence, every absence as a separate pramāṇa in Nyāya, or Yoga's Īśvara as established by the full Nyāya creator inference.

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:end -->

14A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
FACT: Padārtha scheme	ANALYSIS: Reality is classifiable into stable knowable/nameable kinds.	ANALYSIS: Vaiśeṣika ontology loses its map of dravya, guṇa, karma, sāmānya, viśeṣa, samavāya and abhāva.
FACT: Pramāṇa realism / parataḥ-prāmāṇya	ANALYSIS: Cognitions are about real objects, and validity is ascertained through external confirmation or causal conditions.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya cannot distinguish valid cognition from mere appearance in its realist way.
FACT: Vyāpti and induction	ANALYSIS: Universal concomitance can be warranted through observation, upādhi-elimination, tarka and universal-mediated perception.	ANALYSIS: Anumāna falls to Cārvāka scepticism and ordinary proof collapses.
FACT: Sāmānya as real	ANALYSIS: Common predication is grounded in real universals.	ANALYSIS: Classification, word-meaning, sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa and vyāpti-grahaṇa lose their ontological base.
FACT: Samavāya	ANALYSIS: Inseparable relations need a sui generis relation distinct from conjunction.	ANALYSIS: Whole–part, quality–substance and universal–particular relations become unexplained.
FACT: Viśeṣa	ANALYSIS: Exactly similar eternal substances need ultimate individuator.	ANALYSIS: Atoms and selves of the same class risk collapsing into one.
FACT: Asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda	ANALYSIS: Production can generate a genuinely new effect.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya cannot oppose Sāṃkhya satkāryavāda or use prāgabhāva as a causal weapon.
FACT: Paramāṇuvāda	ANALYSIS: Gross physical objects require eternal, partless, imperceptible atoms as ultimate material causes.	ANALYSIS: Atomistic creation and dissolution lose their metaphysical foundation.
FACT: Self as substance with adventitious consciousness	ANALYSIS: Cognition is a quality requiring an enduring ātman-locus and manas-mediated conditions.	ANALYSIS: Memory, recognition, moral agency and liberation of the same subject become hard to explain.
FACT: Apavarga	ANALYSIS: The highest goal is total cessation of suffering, not necessarily positive bliss.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya soteriology is absorbed into Vedāntic or Buddhist models and loses its distinctiveness.
FACT: Īśvara	ANALYSIS: Cosmic order, atomic initiation, karmic dispensation and Vedic authority require omniscient efficient governance.	ANALYSIS: Later Nyāya natural theology and moral cosmology lose their converging centre.

14B. PŪRVAPAKṢA–SIDDHĀNTA LEDGER

Objector	Objection	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
FACT: Cārvāka on vyāpti	FACT: No finite observation proves a universal, and hidden upādhis may always remain.	FACT: Bhūyodarśana, vyabhicāra-adarśana, upādhi-nirāsa, tarka and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa together warrant inference.	ANALYSIS: The reply depends on accepting real universals and extraordinary perception.
FACT: Buddhist Dignāga/Dharmakīrti on universals and apoha	FACT: Universals are unperceived, causally inert and reducible to exclusion of the other.	FACT: Universals are perceived in savikalpaka cognition, inhere by samavāya, and apoha presupposes stable exclusion-classes.	ANALYSIS: Buddhist nominalism remains powerful against reified jāti.
FACT: Buddhist momentariness and no-self	FACT: Only momentary cognitions exist; no enduring substance-self is needed.	FACT: Memory, recognition, agency and moral responsibility require an enduring ātman distinct from the cognition-series.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya must explain why a permanent self has episodic consciousness.
FACT: Buddhist critique of avayavin (whole)	FACT: The whole over and above parts is either identical with parts or different and unintelligible.	FACT: Nyāya infers a real whole because practical cognition and new properties of wholes cannot be reduced to loose aggregates.	ANALYSIS: The whole–part relation leans heavily on samavāya.
FACT: Advaita / Śrīharṣa	FACT: Nyāya definitions invite counterexamples and regress; samavāya and viśeṣa are vulnerable stipulations.	FACT: Nyāya accepts primitive termini where explanation must stop and defends definitions through refined Navya-Nyāya analysis.	ANALYSIS: The dialectical attack exposes the cost of realist precision.
FACT: Advaita on mokṣa	FACT: Liberation without consciousness or bliss is not worth attaining.	FACT: Apavarga is rational because complete cessation of suffering is intrinsically desirable.	ANALYSIS: The "stone-like liberation" objection remains emotionally and philosophically forceful.
FACT: Sāṃkhya	FACT: Satkāryavāda explains causation better because the effect pre-exists in the cause.	FACT: Prāgabhāva shows the effect is absent before production, so production is a new beginning.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya must still explain continuity between cause and effect without latent pre-existence.
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Validity is self-known (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) and Veda needs no divine author.	FACT: Validity and invalidity are known through external checks; meaningful authoritative testimony points to a competent āpta.	ANALYSIS: If authorless Veda is accepted, Nyāya's scriptural God-proof weakens.
FACT: Jaina anekānta	FACT: A rigid category scheme ignores many-sidedness and conditional predication.	FACT: Nyāya replies that debate and inference require determinate categories and non-contradictory predication.	ANALYSIS: Jaina logic highlights contextual limits in Nyāya's fixed classifications.

14C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING

School	Pramāṇas	Validity theory	Error theory	Universals	Causation / atomism	God	Self and liberation
FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Four for Nyāya: pratyakṣa, anumāna, upamāna, śabda.	FACT: Parataḥ for validity and invalidity.	FACT: Anyathākhyāti : misplacement of a real object.	FACT: Real jāti, disciplined by jāti-bādhaka.	FACT: Asatkāryavāda, ārambhavāda, eternal atoms.	FACT: Īśvara as efficient cause and karmic governor.	FACT: Enduring ātman; apavarga as cessation of suffering.
FACT: Sāṃkhya-Yoga	FACT: Usually three: pratyakṣa, anumāna, śabda.	ANALYSIS: Validity is not framed in Nyāya's parataḥ manner.	ANALYSIS: Error tied to misidentification of puruṣa and prakṛti.	ANALYSIS: Less central than tattva-evolution.	FACT: Satkāryavāda; no Vaiśeṣika atomism.	FACT: Sāṃkhya does not require creator God; Yoga accepts special puruṣa Īśvara.	FACT: Many puruṣas; kaivalya as isolation.
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	FACT: More expansive lists, classically including arthāpatti and anupalabdhī in major sub-schools.	FACT: Svataḥ-prāmāṇya for validity.	FACT: Prābhākara akhyāti ; Bhāṭṭa accounts differ.	FACT: Generally realist about word-meaning but not Nyāya-style theistic semantics.	ANALYSIS: Ritual causal potency through apūrva, not atomistic creation-centred.	FACT: No divine author needed for Veda.	FACT: Self accepted; liberation varies by sub-school presentation.
FACT: Advaita	FACT: Six in standard later account.	ANALYSIS: Valid cognition works within vyavahāra but ultimate knowledge sublates duality.	FACT: Anirvacanīya-khyāti .	ANALYSIS: Empirical universals are not ultimately real.	ANALYSIS: Vivarta-style appearance rather than Nyāya ārambha.	FACT: Īśvara is vyāvahārika, Brahman ultimately non-dual.	FACT: Ātman-Brahman identity; mokṣa as liberating knowledge.
FACT: Viśiṣṭādvaita	FACT: Generally accepts perception, inference and scripture.	ANALYSIS: Validity is theistic-realist, not Nyāya parataḥ in the same technical sense.	ANALYSIS: Error does not require Advaita's indefinable object.	FACT: Real plurality as modes of Brahman.	ANALYSIS: Real transformation/qualified non-dual dependence, not atomism as final.	FACT: Nārāyaṇa/Brahman as material and efficient cause.	FACT: Selves are real modes; liberation retains conscious service.
FACT: Buddhism	FACT: Dignāga-Dharmakīrti: two, perception and inference.	ANALYSIS: Often cognition-centred and self-luminosity-friendly.	FACT: Ātmakhyāti/asatkhyāti labels vary in doxography.	FACT: Apoha, not real jāti.	FACT: Momentariness; rejects permanent atoms/self in Nyāya sense.	FACT: No creator God.	FACT: No eternal ātman; nirvāṇa not Nyāya apavarga.
FACT: Jainism	FACT: Multiple pramāṇas with naya-based standpoints.	ANALYSIS: Validity is conditioned by standpoint and non-one-sidedness.	ANALYSIS: Error arises from partial absolutisation.	ANALYSIS: Realism is filtered by anekānta.	ANALYSIS: Atomism exists in a different pluralist framework.	FACT: No creator God in Nyāya sense.	FACT: Jīvas are many; liberation retains perfected consciousness.
FACT: Cārvāka	FACT: Perception alone in the strict formulation.	FACT: Validity tied to perceptibility.	ANALYSIS: Error exposes unreliability beyond perception.	FACT: Rejects real universals as metaphysical excess.	FACT: Materialism without Nyāya inference-based atomism.	FACT: Rejects God.	FACT: Rejects enduring non-material self and mokṣa.

- FACT: **Nyāya vs Vaiśeṣika division of labour.** Nyāya is primarily epistemology, logic and debate, organized around sixteen topics of inquiry and proof; Vaiśeṣika is primarily ontology, organized around padārthas of being. Their later fusion is not identity from the start but a division of labour: Nyāya supplies pramāṇa and dialectic, Vaiśeṣika supplies categories, atomism and viśeṣa-samavāya ontology, and Navya-Nyāya refines both into a highly technical analytic idiom.

- ANALYSIS: **Answer to "one system or two?"** Say: historically two allied systems, doctrinally fused in later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika for UPSC purposes, with distinguishable emphases.

14D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON

Point of contact	Similarity	Disanalogy
ANALYSIS: Vyāpti and Hume's problem of induction	ANALYSIS: Both notice that observed regularity does not by itself entail universal necessity.	FACT: Hume treats the belief as habit of imagination; Nyāya claims warranted universal cognition through upādhi-elimination, tarka and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, because universals are real.
ANALYSIS: Samavāya and Bradley's regress	ANALYSIS: Both see that relations may require further relations and threaten regress.	FACT: Bradley moves toward the unreality of relations in an Absolute; Nyāya stops regress by treating samavāya as self-linking svarūpa-sambandha .
ANALYSIS: Pañcāvayava and Aristotelian syllogism	ANALYSIS: Both offer patterns of valid reasoning.	FACT: Nyāya includes udāharaṇa as an essential empirical example and is primarily a schema of proof to another (parārthānumāna), not a purely formal validity calculus.
ANALYSIS: Nyāya universals and Platonic Forms	ANALYSIS: Both treat universals as real and shareable.	FACT: Nyāya jāti inheres in particulars by samavāya and has no separate transcendent realm; there is no Platonic chorismos .
ANALYSIS: Udayana and design/cosmological arguments or Aquinas' Five Ways	ANALYSIS: Both infer intelligent first cause or ordering intelligence from effects and order.	FACT: Nyāya God is efficient cause only, not creator of matter; atoms and souls are eternal, and God works with karma rather than creation ex nihilo.
ANALYSIS: Apavarga and Epicurean ataraxia / negative good	ANALYSIS: Both can define the goal as absence of disturbance or suffering.	FACT: Nyāya apavarga may involve absence of ordinary consciousness itself, which Western eudaimonism generally does not accept as the highest human good.

- ANALYSIS: Rubric. Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Indian argument; use at most one or two lines after the Nyāya case is complete.

14E. DIRECTIVE DECODER

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika answer	How the closing verdict must be phrased
ANALYSIS: Discuss	ANALYSIS: Breadth plus balanced explanation.	FACT: Define the doctrine, give parts, add one rival and reply.	ANALYSIS: "Thus the doctrine is central because..., though it presupposes..."
ANALYSIS: Examine	ANALYSIS: Internal logic and assumptions.	FACT: State thesis, unpack inferential structure, expose presupposition ledger.	ANALYSIS: "The argument works if its realist presupposition is granted."
ANALYSIS: Critically examine	ANALYSIS: Doctrine plus serious objection.	FACT: Present Nyāya, then named pūrvapakṣa, reply and residual force.	ANALYSIS: "Nyāya answers X, but Y remains the pressure point."
ANALYSIS: Analyse	ANALYSIS: Decomposition into elements and relations.	FACT: Break into padārtha/pramāṇa/khyāti/causal components.	ANALYSIS: "The strength lies in systematic linkage, not isolated claims."
ANALYSIS: Evaluate	ANALYSIS: Normative judgement after evidence.	FACT: Give strengths, weaknesses and final graded judgement.	ANALYSIS: "On balance, it is strong as ..., weaker as ..."
ANALYSIS: Compare	ANALYSIS: Similarity and difference.	FACT: Use a two-column school comparison with exact Sanskrit terms.	ANALYSIS: "The overlap is limited because the metaphysical bases differ."
ANALYSIS: Distinguish	ANALYSIS: Precision between nearby terms.	FACT: Define each term, state locus, relation and example.	ANALYSIS: "Therefore the two are not interchangeable because..."
ANALYSIS: Elucidate	ANALYSIS: Clear exposition with examples.	FACT: Give statement, mechanism, example and exam trap.	ANALYSIS: "This clarifies why Nyāya needs the doctrine in the system."
ANALYSIS: Comment	ANALYSIS: Focused interpretive judgement on a quotation or claim.	FACT: Decode the claim, accept its core, qualify its limits.	ANALYSIS: "The comment is justified in X sense, not in Y sense."
ANALYSIS: Bring out	ANALYSIS: Extraction of significance or implications.	FACT: Show function: what problem the doctrine solves.	ANALYSIS: "Its significance is explanatory rather than merely classificatory."
ANALYSIS: Do you agree?	ANALYSIS: Reasoned stance, not opinion.	FACT: State qualified agreement, then evidence, objection and reply.	ANALYSIS: "I agree only to the extent that..., because..."

14F. GRADED VERDICT ON NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA

Strong points

- FACT: **Logic and inference.** Nyāya offers the most developed Indian account of inference, debate, hetu-testing and fallacy-analysis.
- FACT: **Answer to scepticism.** Its account of vyāpti-grahaṇa is a serious realist reply to Cārvāka-style and induction-style scepticism.
- FACT: **Disciplined ontology.** Vaiśeṣika does not merely multiply entities; checks such as jāti-bādhaka show an internal economy of universals.
- FACT: **Natural theology.** Udayana gives the most rigorous Indian cumulative case for God as efficient cause, karmic governor and Vedic āpta.

Weak points

- ANALYSIS: **Samavāya and viśeṣa.** Both function as stipulated termini against regress, so critics can call them explanatory placeholders.
- ANALYSIS: **Liberation.** Apavarga as absence of pleasure, pain and ordinary cognition invites the stone-like liberation objection.

- ANALYSIS: **God and karma.** Making God dispense fruits according to beginningless karma protects justice but limits divine independence.
- ANALYSIS: **Ontological proliferation.** Abhāva, samavāya, viśeṣa and multiple categories can look excessive to Buddhist, Advaitin and Cārvāka critics.

Genuinely contested points

- ☐ **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa.** It is contested whether universal-mediated perception is genuine perception or an ad hoc device for induction.
- ☐ **One system or two.** Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika are historically distinct but later fused; UPSC answers must preserve both facts.
- ☐ **Pot–potter analogy.** It is contested whether an embodied artisan analogy can bear the weight of proving a bodiless cosmic maker.

Ready verdict lines

- ANALYSIS: **10 marks.** "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is strongest as a realist logic-ontology, but its primitive relations and particularizers remain vulnerable."
- ANALYSIS: **15 marks.** "Its achievement is systematic: pramāṇa secures knowledge, padārtha secures being and Īśvara secures order; its weakness is that samavāya, viśeṣa and unconscious mokṣa are asserted as much as proved."
- ANALYSIS: **20 marks.** "A fair verdict is graded: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika gives Indian philosophy its most rigorous realism, inference-theory and natural theology, yet the very devices that make the system complete—samavāya, viśeṣa, sāmānyalakṣaṇa and karma-bound Īśvara—are also its deepest contested points."

15. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 22 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q5(a)	10 marks	How do the Vaiśeṣika philosophers explain the difference of the relationships in the two cases—(i) the brown colour of the table and (ii) the book on the table? Discuss.
2018	Q5(d)	10 marks	How do the Buddhists and the Nyāya philosophers explain our knowledge of 'the absence of the jar on the table'? Answer in detail.
2018	Q6(a)	20 marks	How do the Naiyāyikas prove the existence of God? Do the Yoga philosophers prove God in the same way? If yes, how? And if no, why? Give reasons for your answer.
2019	Q5(a)	10 marks	Justify the status of Abhāva as a category in Vaiśeṣika philosophy.
2019	Q6(b)	15 marks	What is the role of Jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa in explaining Anyathākhyāti?
2019	Q7(a)	20 marks	How does Udayana prove the existence of God through Kāryāt, Āyojanāt, Dhṛtyādeḥ and Śruteḥ? Discuss.
2020	Q6(c)	15 marks	Explain the concepts of 'Anyathāsiddha' and 'Ananyathāsiddha' in the context of Asatkāryavāda.
2020	Q8(b)	15 marks	Critically evaluate the logical and metaphysical status of Viśeṣa in the context of Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.
2021	Q5(a)	10 marks	Does the seed contain the tree? Discuss with reference to Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.
2021	Q5(b)	10 marks	Explain with reference to Nyāya Philosophy, the nature of śabda as the advice of āpta (a reliable person).
2021	Q5(c)	10 marks	Is 'inseparability' (ayuta-siddhatva) a necessary condition or a sufficient condition for defining characteristics (lakṣaṇa) of samavāya (inherence)? Explain with reference to Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2022	Q5(b)	10 marks	What is the ontological status of Sāmānya, according to Vaiśeṣika Philosophy? Critically examine.
2022	Q7(c)	15 marks	How do Naiyāyikas respond to Cārvāka's objections against inference (anumāna) and establish inference as an independent means of knowledge? Critically discuss.
2023	Q5(d)	10 marks	Present an account of Vaiśeṣika's view of negation in the light of their statement — "Negation always has a counterpositive and absolute negation is an impossibility."
2023	Q6(c)	15 marks	Elucidate Naiyāyikas view of ordinary and extraordinary perception. Are they justified in accepting that universals are perceived? Discuss.
2023	Q7(a)	20 marks	Elucidate Naiyāyikas account of fallacies of the middle term in relation to five characteristics of valid middle term.
2023	Q8(b)	15 marks	Write a note on Nyāya notion of Prāgabdhāva (prior non-existence). How does this notion help Naiyāyikas in defending their position on causation against the Sāṃkhya view of causation? Critically discuss.
2024	Q5(b)	10 marks	Explain the six reasons offered by the Naiyāyikas to prove the existence of the self.
2024	Q5(c)	10 marks	Do these two sentences "Air does not have heat" and "Air is not fire" refer to the same type of absence or abhāva, according to the Vaiśeṣikas? Discuss.
2025	Q5(b)	10 marks	Present an exposition of the debate between Naiyāyikas and Buddhists with reference to the notion of Pramāṇa and Pramāṇaphala.
2025	Q5(e)	10 marks	Present an exposition of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika's theory of causation.
2025	Q6(a)	20 marks	Present a detailed account of Gautama's definition of Perception.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

16. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks)

16.1 For a 10-marker

Define the term technically.
List its parts/classification.
Add one contrast or one objection.
Close with one line of significance.

16.2 For a 15-marker

Intro: state the problem Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika solves.
Body A: doctrine with technical vocabulary.
Body B: argument or classification.
Body C: one objection and reply / one comparison.
Conclusion: precise evaluative line.

16.3 For a 20-marker

Frame: locate the doctrine in the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika system.
Exposition: full statement with subdivisions.
Analysis: argument structure and presuppositions.
Debate: rival view plus criticism and response.
Verdict: what remains philosophically strong and where difficulty persists.

17. LINK-OUTS

- Buddhism.md — contrast on self, momentariness and pramāṇa.
- Samkhya.md — satkāryavāda contrast.
- Mimamsa.md — svataḥ-prāmāṇya, śabda and akhyāti comparison.
- Vedanta.md — anirvacanīya-khyāti and self-consciousness contrast.
- ../_themes/Pramana-across-schools.md — comparative pramāṇa map.
- ../_themes/Causation-across-schools.md — ārambhavāda in context.
- ../_themes/Self-and-liberation-across-schools.md — ātman and mokṣa contrasts.

- ../_PYQ-Indian-Philosophy-2018-2025.md — Indian Philosophy PYQ bank.
- ../paper-2/philosophy-of-religion/Proofs-for-God.md — cross-paper theism and critique.

SOURCES

- Gautama, *Nyāya-sūtra*, in standard textbook exposition and paraphrase where exact wording is uncertain.
- Kaṇāda, *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*, in standard textbook exposition.
- Udayana, *Nyāyakusumāñjali*, for theistic proofs as commonly transmitted in Indian philosophy surveys.
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, especially discussion of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika realism and theism.

CURRENT LINKAGE STATUS

FACT: Search result, 16 August 2026: No fresh official India-wide development specifically concerning Nyaya, Vaisesika, or classical Indian logic was verifiable for February-August 2026. Ongoing Indian Knowledge Systems activity remains a broad educational context, not evidence for any doctrine. This package therefore uses no decorative current-affairs claim.

Direct local source anchors

- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta, local OCR edition, especially file pages 136-170 for Nyaya realism, pramana, perception, inference and testimony.
- FACT: C. D. Sharma, local OCR edition, especially file pages 173-186 for Vaisesika categories, atomism, God and critical evaluation.
- FACT: The repository PYQ bank controls wording, marks and ownership for all 22 questions below.

PART II - SOLVED PYQs, PRACTICE AND ANSWER TRAINING

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: How do the Vaisesika philosophers explain the difference between the brown colour of the table and the book on the table?

Model solution

The brown colour and table stand in **samavaya**; the book and table stand in **samyoga**.

Samavaya is eternal, intimate inherence between inseparably related entities: quality and substance, action and substance, universal and particular, whole and parts, or visesa and eternal substance. Brownness cannot exist independently and then be placed on the table; it inheres in its locus.

Samyoga is conjunction between independently existing substances. The book and table can exist apart, their relation is produced and destructible, and either relatum may move away.

Test	Brown-table	Book-table
Relation	samavaya	samyoga
Relata	quality-substance	substance-substance
Separability	ayutasiddha	yutasiddha
Duration	relation treated as eternal	produced and destructible

Verdict: Vaisesika needs samavaya because conjunction cannot explain the constitutive unity of dependent qualities with substances.

Why this earns marks: It names both relations, gives their ontological tests, applies them to the examples, and states the philosophical need for inference.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: How do Buddhists and Nyaya explain knowledge of "the absence of the jar on the table"?

Model solution

Nyaya-Vaisesika treats **abhava** as a real category. When a competent perceiver apprehends the table under suitable conditions and no jar is present, the non-existence of the jar is directly known. The table is the locus; jar is the **pratiyogin**, the counterpositive whose absence is qualified.

Buddhist analysis avoids a separately existing negative entity. Absence-cognition is explained through the positive perception of the bare locus together with conceptual exclusion, non-apprehension, or inference from failure to perceive an otherwise perceptible jar.

Nyaya argues that the cognition has a determinate object—jar-absence—and cannot be reduced to mere table-perception, because "the table is jarless" differs from simply "this is a table." The Buddhist replies that reifying every meaningful negation needlessly multiplies entities.

Verdict: Nyaya offers ontological realism about absence; Buddhism offers an economical epistemic-conceptual analysis. Nyaya better preserves the intentional object of negative judgement but pays a higher ontological cost.

Why this earns marks: It compares the object, mechanism and philosophical cost of both accounts rather than describing only Nyaya abhava.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2018 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: How do Naiyayikas prove God? Do Yoga philosophers prove God in the same way?

Model solution

Nyaya infers Isvara as an omniscient, eternal and disembodied efficient cause who arranges eternal atoms, dispenses karmic fruits and grounds authoritative Vedic testimony. The world is an effect composed of parts and exhibiting order; like a pot, it requires an intelligent maker. Atomic conjunction also requires direction, and moral results require an omniscient governor.

The main Nyaya routes are:

karyat	→ world as effect implies maker
ayojanat	→ atomic arrangement implies arranger
dhrtyadeh	→ support and order imply governor
padat	→ word-meaning convention implies author
pratyayatah	→ Vedic trustworthiness implies omniscient source
sruteh	→ scripture testifies to God

Yoga accepts **Isvara**, but its emphasis differs. Patanjali defines Isvara as a special purusa untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits and latent deposits. Isvara is the unsurpassed teacher and an aid to samadhi through Isvara-pranidhana. Classical Yoga does not require Isvara as the material cause and does not develop the same cumulative cosmological-natural-theological proof structure as Udayana.

Nyaya's God coordinates atoms and karma; Yoga's Isvara is primarily a unique spiritual exemplar and meditative support. Later commentators may strengthen Yoga theism, but the doctrinal functions remain distinct.

Objections arise from Samkhya, which sees unconscious prakrti as sufficient; Mimamsa, which regards the Veda as authorless; and the problem of evil. Nyaya replies that atoms and adrsta lack intelligence, authorless sentences cannot establish purposive convention, and God allocates rather than authors karmic desert.

Verdict: Both admit Isvara, but not by the same route or for the same systematic task. Nyaya offers inferential natural theology; Yoga integrates a special purusa into soteriological discipline.

Why this earns marks: It gives Nyaya's proof family, precisely distinguishes Yoga's Isvara, includes rival objections, and answers the comparative demand.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2019 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: Justify the status of Abhava as a category in Vaisheshika philosophy.

Model solution

Abhava is admitted because negative cognitions are objective and irreducible. "There is no jar on the floor" is not merely cognition of the floor; it presents the floor as qualified by jar-absence.

The four forms are:

Abhava	Meaning
Pragabhava	prior absence before production
Pradhvamsabhava	posterior absence after destruction
Atyantabhava	absolute absence between incompatible entities
Anyonyabhava	mutual absence or difference

Every absence has a locus and counterpositive. This prevents "nothing" from becoming an independent void. Abhava is nameable, knowable and explanatorily necessary, so it satisfies the broad padartha criterion.

Critics object that absence is only failure to perceive. Nyaya replies that non-apprehension under adequate conditions yields a positive, determinate judgement about what is absent and where.

Why this earns marks: It justifies rather than merely lists abhava, gives the fourfold classification, and addresses the reduction-to-non-perception objection.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2019 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: What is the role of Jñanalaksana-pratyakṣa in explaining Anyathakhyati?

Model solution

Anyathakhyati explains illusion as mislocation of a real property: in "this is silver," the presented shell is perceived here, while real silver remembered from elsewhere supplies silverness. Error joins two real elements in a false relation.

Jñanalaksana-pratyakṣa is extraordinary perception in which prior cognition functions as a special mediator. The present shell triggers memory of silver; through cognition-mediated contact, silverness is presented as belonging to the shell.

visual contact with shell
↓
revival of prior silver-cognition
↓
cognition-mediated presentation of silverness
↓
"this shell is silver"

It explains why illusion feels perceptual rather than like detached memory. The defect lies not in the existence of the relata but in their predicative synthesis.

Advaita objects that absent silver cannot be perceptually related to the present locus; Yogacara questions the external realist framework. Nyaya replies that extraordinary contact is required precisely to explain cross-locational presentation without inventing an indescribable object.

Verdict: Jñanalaksana is the epistemic mechanism that makes anyathakhyati a realist error theory, though critics may see it as an ad hoc extension of perception.

Why this earns marks: It separates the theory of error from its perceptual mechanism, gives the causal sequence, and adds the strongest criticism.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2019 Q7(a), 20 marks

Question: How does Udayana prove God through Karyat, Ayojanat, Dhrtiyadeh and Sruteh?

Model solution

Udayana's proofs form a cumulative explanation of production, arrangement, stability and authoritative revelation.

Karyat: The world is an effect because it is composite, mutable and dependent. Effects such as pots require intelligent makers; therefore the world requires an omniscient maker. God is efficient, not material, cause because eternal atoms supply material.

Ayojanat: Atoms are inert and adrsta is non-conscious. Their purposive initial conjunction into dyads and complex bodies requires intelligent direction.

Dhrtiyadeh: The world's continued support, coordinated order and dissolution require a governor. Natural regularity and the allocation of karmic fruits are not explained by blind matter alone.

Sruteh: Scripture testifies to God. Nyaya supplements this with the argument that reliable Vedic discourse requires an omniscient source; sentencehood and authority are difficult to ground in an authorless text.

The proofs presuppose that order is explanatory evidence of intelligence, unconscious causes cannot organize themselves teleologically, and testimony ultimately depends on a trustworthy speaker.

Samkhya argues that prakrti suffices; Mimamsa defends an authorless Veda; Buddhists reject permanent creator and atoms. Nyaya replies that unconscious prakrti or adrsta cannot select morally fitted outcomes, while an omniscient governor coordinates pre-existing materials and karmic law.

The problem of evil remains: if God is omnipotent and benevolent, suffering is difficult. Nyaya treats God as impartial administrator of beginningless karma, though the critic may ask why such a system is sustained.

Verdict: Udayana is strongest when read cumulatively: no single analogy demonstrates God, but maker, arranger, sustainer and authoritative speaker jointly form Nyaya's best explanation.

Why this earns marks: It explains each named proof, exposes presuppositions, handles three rival schools and gives a graded evaluation.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2020 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain Anyathasiddha and Ananyathasiddha in the context of Asatkaryavada.

Model solution

Nyaya defines a cause as an **ananyathasiddha** antecedent: an indispensable prior condition whose relevance to the effect cannot be explained otherwise. Mere temporal priority is insufficient, because countless earlier events are causally irrelevant.

An **anyathasiddha** antecedent is otherwise established or irrelevant to production. The potter's father precedes the pot but is not its cause; the colour of the stick used in making a pot is incidental to its productive role.

The distinction disciplines **asatkaryavada**, according to which the effect is a new beginning. A pot does not pre-exist in clay, yet its production is not ex nihilo: clay, conjunction, potter and instruments are causally necessary in distinct ways.

Nyaya distinguishes:

Cause	Example in pot
Samavayi	clay/parts inhering in effect
Asamavayi	conjunction or qualities inhering in material cause
Nimitta	potter, wheel and instruments

Only relevant indispensable antecedents enter the causal set. Critics ask whether indispensability is discovered without already knowing causal laws. Nyaya answers through repeated observation, elimination of conditions and explanatory analysis.

Verdict: The pair prevents arambhavada from collapsing into the claim that every antecedent causes every later event.

Why this earns marks: It defines both terms, applies them, links them to the three causes, and states their role in securing disciplined new-production theory.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2020 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate the logical and metaphysical status of Visesa.

Model solution

Visesa is ultimate particularity, admitted to distinguish numerically different eternal substances that share all general properties: atoms of one element, selves, minds, time, space and ether. Compound objects differ through parts and qualities; indiscernible eternal simples require a primitive differentiator.

Logically, visesa grounds numerical distinction where qualitative criteria fail. Metaphysically, it is eternal, innumerable, resident by samavaya in eternal substances, and self-differentiating.

The main objection is regress: if visesa differentiates atoms, what differentiates one visesa from another? Vaisesika replies that visesas are **svato-vyavrtta**, self-excluding; demanding another differentiator misunderstands their primitive function.

A second objection calls visesa an ontological IOU—an imperceptible entity postulated only to save plurality. The realist reply is abductive: if multiple eternal reals are required by causal and moral explanation, a principle of individuation is unavoidable.

Verdict: Visesa is logically intelligible as primitive thisness, but its metaphysical force depends on prior commitment to plural eternal substances. It completes the system more than it independently proves itself.

Why this earns marks: It covers function, locus, regress, self-differentiation and the deeper dependence of visesa on realist pluralism.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2021 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: Does the seed contain the tree? Discuss with reference to Nyaya-Vaisesika.

Model solution

No. Nyaya-Vaisesika defends **asatkaryavada**: the effect does not pre-exist as an actual effect in its material cause. The tree is a new product, although its production depends on seed-material, water, soil, heat and other conditions.

If the tree already existed in the seed, production would be redundant; the distinction between cause and effect would collapse; and the same effect should be available without the complete causal complex. The seed possesses capacity, not a concealed tree.

The relation is explained through prior absence:

pragabhava of tree + complete causal conditions
↓
new production of tree
↓
destruction may yield pradhvamsabhava

Samkhya objects that what is absolutely non-existent cannot arise. Nyaya replies that "non-existent before production" means prior absence in the cause, not impossibility like a hare's horn.

Why this earns marks: It states the exact doctrine, distinguishes capacity from pre-existence, uses pragabhava and answers the Samkhya objection.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2021 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: Explain sabda as the advice of apta.

Model solution

Sabda is valid verbal testimony, classically defined as the statement or instruction of an **apta**—a competent and trustworthy speaker who knows the fact and communicates it without intention to deceive.

Its validity requires:

1. a reliable speaker;
2. meaningful words governed by convention;
3. syntactic expectancy, compatibility and proximity;
4. a hearer who understands the sentence;
5. absence of defeating conditions.

Testimony is independent because much knowledge—history, distant places, specialized science and ordinary social facts—cannot be reconstructed by each hearer through direct perception or inference. The hearer may infer the speaker's reliability, but sentence-understanding yields its object through linguistic cognition.

Vedic testimony is treated as supremely reliable through divine or omniscient authorship in Nyaya. Mimamsa instead grounds Vedic authority in authorlessness.

Why this earns marks: It defines apta, states conditions of verbal cognition, justifies independent pramana status, and adds the Nyaya-Mimamsa contrast.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2021 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Is ayutasiddhatva a necessary or sufficient condition for samavaya?

Model solution

Ayutasiddhatva means inseparability: one relatum cannot exist independently in the relevant way from the other. It is necessary for samavaya because inherence connects whole-parts, quality-substance, action-substance, universal-instance and visesa-eternal substance.

It is not by itself sufficient. Mere inseparability can arise from other facts, and samavaya requires a distinctive constitutive relation between ontologically dependent relata. The relation must also be non-conjunctive, intimate and not produced like samyoga.

For example, colour cannot exist without some substance, and this supports inherence. But two tightly joined physical objects may be practically inseparable while remaining connected only by conjunction.

The regress objection asks whether samavaya needs another relation to connect it to its relata. Vaisesika stops the regress by treating samavaya as self-linking and sui generis.

Verdict: Ayutasiddhatva is a necessary diagnostic but not a complete sufficient definition unless supplemented by the specific locus-relatum structure of inherence.

Why this earns marks: It directly answers necessary versus sufficient, uses examples, and shows why the definition needs supplementation.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2022 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: What is the ontological status of Samanya according to Vaisesika? Critically examine.

Model solution

Samanya is a real, eternal universal, one in many, inhering in substances, qualities or actions. Cow-ness is not merely a word or mental image; it objectively grounds common predication and classification across individual cows.

Universals form higher and lower orders: *satta* or being is maximally general, while cow-ness is restricted. Samanya is related to instances by samavaya.

Buddhist apoha theory objects that commonness can be explained by exclusion of non-cows without a universal. A further problem asks how one entity is wholly present in many places. Vaisesika replies that a universal is non-spatially one and multiply instantiated, not physically divided.

The six jati-badhakas restrict indiscriminate multiplication of universals, showing that Vaisesika realism is disciplined rather than unlimited.

Verdict: Samanya gives a robust basis for classification and inference, but its independent reality is less economical than nominalist or exclusion accounts.

Why this earns marks: It states samanya's full ontological profile, relation to particulars, internal restrictions, and the Buddhist challenge.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2022 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: How do Naiyayikas answer Carvaka objections to inference and establish anumana as an independent pramana?

Model solution

Carvaka argues that inference depends on **vyapti**, universal concomitance, which cannot be known. Perception covers only finite cases; inference used to establish vyapti becomes circular; and hidden conditions may produce exceptions.

Nyaya replies that vyapti is not an a priori leap. It is secured through repeated agreement in presence and absence, absence of counter-instance, elimination of **upadhi**, and **tarka**:

bhuyodarsana + vyabhicara-adarsana
+ upadhi-nirasa + tarka
↓
qualified grasp of vyapti
↓
paramarsa
↓
inferential cognition

Inference is indispensable even to Carvaka criticism. To claim that unobserved cases may differ is itself an inferential generalization. Everyday action—fire from smoke, danger from signs, another mind from behaviour—also presupposes reliable transition beyond perception.

Nyaya does not claim infallible induction from a small sample. Vyapti is fallible in discovery but corrigible through counterexamples and condition-analysis. Once correctly known and applied through paksa-dharmata and paramarsa, it produces new knowledge.

Verdict: Nyaya defeats global scepticism about inference, though its account of universal necessity remains vulnerable to the Humean problem that observed regularity does not logically compel all unobserved cases.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs Carvaka's strongest objections, explains the complete Nyaya method, exposes performative dependence, and offers a critical verdict.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2023 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: Explain the claim that negation always has a counterpositive and absolute negation is impossible.

Model solution

An absence is always the absence **of something** in a locus. The absent entity is the **pratiyogin** or counterpositive; the place where it is absent is the **anuyogin** or locus. "There is no jar on the floor" means jar-absence qualified by the floor.

Absolute featureless nothing cannot be cognized, named or distinguished. Even **atyantabhava**, often translated absolute absence, remains relational: colour is absent from air at all times, or a hare's horn is absent as a possible entity, relative to a specified counterpositive.

Mutual absence explains difference: a pot is not cloth and cloth is not pot. Prior and posterior absences explain before-production and after-destruction.

Verdict: Vaisesika negation is relationally realist, not commitment to an independent Nothing. Its strength is logical determinacy; its cost is treating negative facts as ontological entities.

Why this earns marks: It explains counterpositive and locus, clarifies atyantabhava, and connects the claim to all major forms of absence.

Solved PYQ 15 - 2023 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain ordinary and extraordinary perception. Are Naiyayikas justified in accepting that universals are perceived?

Model solution

Ordinary perception (**laukika**) arises through normal sense-object contact and includes external perception through five senses and internal perception through manas. Nyaya analyses six modes of contact, such as conjunction, inherence in the conjoined, and inherence of a universal in a quality.

Extraordinary perception (**alaukika**) has three forms:

1. **Samanyalaksana:** perception of many or all instances through a perceived universal.
2. **Jnanalaksana:** prior cognition mediates presentation, as in seeing fragrant sandalwood or illusory silver.
3. **Yogaja:** extraordinary perception generated by yogic discipline.

Nyaya justifies universal-perception by arguing that recognition "this is a cow" includes direct awareness of cow-ness; otherwise classification and vyapti would lack objective grounding. Samanyalaksana also helps explain knowledge extending beyond presently sensed particulars.

Buddhists object that perception is of unique particulars and universals are conceptual constructions. The Nyaya account risks making perception too intellectual and overextending it to unobserved members.

Verdict: Ordinary perception is plausible realism; samanyalaksana is systematically useful but the least secure form because it blurs perception and conceptual generalization.

Why this earns marks: It gives the complete classification, explains the universal argument, and critically distinguishes the stronger and weaker parts.

Solved PYQ 16 - 2023 Q7(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain fallacies of the middle term in relation to five characteristics of a valid middle term.

Model solution

A valid **hetu** must satisfy five marks:

1. **Paksadharmata:** present in the subject.
2. **Sapakasattva:** present in positive instances where the probandum occurs.
3. **Vipakasattvabhava:** absent in negative instances.
4. **Abadhitatva:** not contradicted by stronger knowledge.
5. **Asatpratipaksatva:** not opposed by an equally strong counter-reason.

Hetvabhasas arise when these conditions fail:

Fallacy	Defect	Illustration
Savyabhicara	irregular reason; fails concomitance	hill has fire because knowable
Viruddha	reason proves opposite	sound is eternal because produced
Satpratipaksa	counterbalanced reason	opposing valid-looking hetu
Asiddha	reason unestablished in paksa	sky-lotus is fragrant because lotus
Badhita	contradicted by stronger cognition	fire is cold because substance

Some classifications align subtypes differently, but the logical core is failure of subject-presence, positive/negative concomitance, undefeatedness or non-opposition.

The fallacy doctrine is not merely a list. It is the negative mirror of **vyapti**: each apparent reason reveals how inference fails when the middle term does not reliably connect paksa and sadhya.

Critically, Nyaya combines formal and material relevance. It does not validate an argument by form alone; the reason must be objectively connected with the property proved. This strengthens empirical reasoning but makes validity depend on a substantive account of universal relation.

Verdict: The five characteristics and five fallacies form a rigorous diagnostic system, though their success ultimately depends on the contested possibility of knowing vyapti.

Why this earns marks: It lists all marks and fallacies, maps defects to conditions, and explains their unity through vyapti rather than rote taxonomy.

Solved PYQ 17 - 2023 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: Explain Pragabhava and how it helps Nyaya defend causation against Samkhya.

Model solution

Pragabhava is the beginningless prior absence of an effect in its material cause before production. It has no beginning but ends when the effect arises. Pot-absence exists in clay before pot-production.

This supports **asatkaryavada**: the effect as effect is not already actual in the cause. Production terminates its prior absence and begins a new composite entity.

Nyaya argues against Samkhya:

1. If the effect already exists, production is redundant.
2. Cause and effect become indistinguishable.
3. The need for instruments and agents is unexplained.
4. We ordinarily judge "the pot did not exist; now it exists."

Samkhya replies that non-being cannot become being and that a specific cause produces only a specific effect because the effect is latent. Nyaya distinguishes prior absence from absolute impossibility. The pot is absent as an actual whole but possible because appropriate material and causal capacities exist.

Verdict: Pragabhava gives arambhavada a precise temporal ontology. It explains novelty better than latent-effect theory, but still depends on the controversial realism of absences and wholes.

Why this earns marks: It defines temporal structure, derives asatkaryavada, reconstructs both schools, and gives a balanced evaluation.

Solved PYQ 18 - 2024 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: Explain the six reasons offered by Naiyayikas to prove the self.

Model solution

Nyaya infers an enduring self as the substance possessing cognition, desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain, merit and demerit.

Six common routes are:

1. **Memory:** one subject connects past experience and present recollection.
2. **Recognition:** "this is the same" presupposes continuity.
3. **Desire:** present striving refers to previously experienced satisfaction.
4. **Coordination of senses:** one knower integrates colour, touch and taste.
5. **Agency and moral desert:** one agent owns action and fruit.
6. **Possessive awareness:** "I know," "I am happy" presents qualities as belonging to a subject.

Body, senses and manas cannot alone be self: the body changes, senses are multiple instruments, and atomic manas coordinates only one cognition at a time.

Buddhists explain these through causal streams. Nyaya replies that succession explains transmission but not ownership and cross-modal unity.

Why this earns marks: It provides six distinct arguments, identifies self as substance of mental qualities, and adds the Buddhist challenge.

Solved PYQ 19 - 2024 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Do "Air does not have heat" and "Air is not fire" refer to the same type of absence?

Model solution

No. "Air does not have heat" expresses **atyantabhava** of the quality heat in air: heat is absent from air across times under the school's elemental classification.

"Air is not fire" expresses **anyonyabhava**, mutual absence or difference. Air is non-fire, just as fire is non-air; one entity is absent as the identity of the other.

Sentence	Absence	Counterpositive
Air lacks heat	atyantabhava	heat
Air is not fire	anyonyabhava	fire as identical with air

The first denies a property in a locus; the second denies identity between substances. Both require a counterpositive, but their relational structures differ.

Why this earns marks: It identifies each absence, explains property-negation versus identity-negation, and uses counterpositive analysis.

Solved PYQ 20 - 2025 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: Present the debate between Naiyayikas and Buddhists on Pramana and Pramanaphala.

Model solution

Nyaya distinguishes **pramana**, the instrument or operative cause of valid cognition, from **pramanaphala**, its result. In perception, sense-object contact and the cognitive process generate a true cognition whose practical result may be acceptance, rejection or indifference.

Buddhist epistemologists, especially Dharmakirti's tradition, treat pramana and result as non-different phases of one cognition. A cognition is authoritative by manifesting an object-form and enabling successful activity; no separate enduring knower or instrument-substance is needed.

Nyaya argues that instrument and result must be distinguished to preserve causal explanation: an axe is not the cutting-result. Buddhists reply that cognition is self-performing and self-disclosing; splitting it creates unnecessary entities and temporal gaps.

Verdict: Nyaya offers a richer causal analysis; Buddhism offers event-economy. The dispute reflects their larger contrast between substance realism and momentary cognition.

Why this earns marks: It clearly states both positions, gives the causal analogy and links the epistemic dispute to their ontologies.

Solved PYQ 21 - 2025 Q5(e), 10 marks

Question: Present Nyaya-Vaisesika's theory of causation.

Model solution

Nyaya-Vaisesika defends **asatkaryavada** or **arambhavada**: the effect does not pre-exist as an actual effect in its cause; it is newly produced when an indispensable causal complex operates.

Three causes are distinguished:

Cause	Function	Pot example
Samavayi	material/inherent cause	clay or constituent parts
Asamavayi	qualities/relations inhering in material cause	conjunction of clay-parts
Nimitta	efficient occasion	potter, wheel, stick

A cause is an *ananyathasiddha* antecedent, not merely anything earlier. Production terminates *pragabhava*. The effect is a real whole inhering in its parts, not merely a collection.

Samkhya objects that non-being cannot arise. Nyaya replies that prior non-existence differs from absolute impossibility and that causal capacity explains determinate production.

Why this earns marks: It states the doctrine, three causes, relevance condition, *pragabhava* and the principal rival objection.

Solved PYQ 22 - 2025 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: Present a detailed account of Gautama's definition of Perception.

Model solution

Gautama defines perception as cognition produced by sense-object contact, **avyapadesya**, **avyabhicari** and **vyavasayatmaka**. Each clause excludes a rival defect.

Indriyarthasannikarsotpanna: Perception is generated by contact between sense and object. External senses apprehend their proper objects; manas mediates internal states.

Avyapadesya: It is not essentially produced by verbal testimony. The clause protects direct presentation from dependence on words and is often associated with the non-conceptual phase.

Avyabhicari: It is non-errant. Illusion caused by defect is not valid perception or *prama*.

Vyavasayatmaka: It is determinate or definite, excluding doubt. Later Nyaya distinguishes **nirvikalpaka** indeterminate awareness from **savikalpaka** qualified judgement and interprets the definition accordingly.

Ordinary perception includes six contact-relations and external/internal forms. Extraordinary perception includes *samanyalaksana*, *jñanalaksana* and *yogaja*.

Criticisms arise. Buddhists deny conceptual perception of universals; Advaita treats some ordinary cognitions as superimposed; modern critics question extraordinary perception. Nyaya replies that recognition, classification, cross-modal illusion and yogic testimony require a wider contact theory.

The definition also faces a circularity concern: if perception is defined as unerring cognition, how is truth known? Nyaya uses **paratah-pramanya**—validity is established through successful activity and subsequent cognition, not built into mere subjective certainty.

Verdict: Gautama's definition systematically excludes testimony, error and doubt while grounding perception in realism. Its ordinary core is strong; its extraordinary extensions are more contestable.

Why this earns marks: It analyses every clause, integrates later classifications, adds validity theory and critically separates ordinary from extraordinary perception.

Integrated MCQ Loop - 24 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Classical Vaisesika finally recognizes: A. seven padarthas B. four padarthas C. sixteen padarthas D. twenty-four padarthas	A	Dravya, guna, karma, samanya, visesa, samavaya and abhava.
2	Cognition is classified as a quality of: A. manas B. atman C. akasa D. kala	B	Consciousness is a guna of self, not its essence.
3	The relation between colour and substance is: A. samyoga B. svarupa C. samavaya D. tadatmya	C	A quality inheres inseparably in substance.
4	Mutual absence is called: A. pragabhava B. pradhvamsabhava C. atyantabhava D. anyonyabhava	D	It grounds difference such as pot is not cloth.
5	Nyaya admits which pramanas? A. perception, inference, comparison, testimony B. perception alone C. six including arthapatti D. three including anupalabdhi	A	These are the standard four.
6	The cognition immediately responsible for inferential knowledge is: A. samsaya B. paramarsa C. smriti D. tarka alone	B	Paramarsa applies vyapti-qualified hetu to the paksa.
7	Failure of positive concomitance produces a defect in: A. paksadharmata B. abadhitatva C. sapaksasattva D. asatpratipaksatva	C	A valid reason must occur in positive instances.
8	Jnanalaksana is a form of: A. inference B. testimony C. ordinary perception D. extraordinary perception	D	Prior cognition mediates an unusual presentation.
9	Sabda is valid when issued by: A. apta B. any speaker C. only a Vedic priest D. an anonymous source	A	Apta is competent and trustworthy.
10	Anyathakhyati explains error as: A. non-apprehension B. mislocation of a real property C. creation of unreal object D. indescribable appearance	B	Real shell and real silverness are falsely synthesized.
11	The self is inferred as substance of: A. atoms B. universals C. cognition, desire and effort D. sound alone	C	Mental states are qualities requiring a locus.
12	Nyaya liberation is primarily: A. eternal pleasure B. union with Brahman C. heavenly embodiment D. cessation of suffering and its causes	D	Apavarga is release from pain, karma and cognition-producing embodiment.
13	Karyat argues to God from: A. world as effect B. Vedic eternity C. yogic perception D. moral intuition alone	A	A composite effect points to intelligent maker.
14	Ayojanat concerns: A. word meaning B. atomic combination C. memory D. universals	B	Inert atoms require intelligent arrangement.
15	Nyaya causation is: A. satkaryavada B. vivartavada C. asatkaryavada D. svabhavavada	C	Effect is newly produced.
16	The inherent/material cause of a pot is: A. potter B. wheel C. conjunction alone D. clay	D	Clay is samavayi cause.
17	Prior absence is: A. pragabhava B. anyonyabhava C. samavaya D. pradhvamsabhava	A	It ends when the effect is produced.
18	Ultimate differentiator of eternal simples is: A. samanya B. visesa C. guna D. karma	B	Visesa individuates atoms and selves.
19	Vaibhasika criticism is most relevant to Nyaya's: A. God only B. testimony only C. enduring substances and universals D. Yoga practice	C	Buddhist realism still rejects Nyaya's enduring category structure.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
20	A cause merely earlier but irrelevant is: A. ananyathasiddha B. nimitta C. samavayi D. anyathasiddha	D	Temporal priority alone is insufficient.
21	The five-member inference begins with: A. pratijna B. hetu C. udaharana D. upanaya	A	Thesis precedes reason, example, application and conclusion.
22	An unestablished middle is: A. viruddha B. asiddha C. badhita D. savyabhicara	B	The reason is not established in the subject.
23	Nyaya validity is generally known: A. intrinsically only B. by revelation C. extrinsically through confirming conditions D. never	C	Paratah-pramanya uses successful activity and subsequent cognition.
24	Vaisesika atomism treats atoms as: A. produced wholes B. qualitatively identical C. mental constructions D. eternal, partless and element-specific	D	Earth, water, fire and air atoms have distinct qualities.

Remedial MCQ Loop - 8 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
25	Samyoga differs from samavaya because it is: A. produced between separable substances B. eternal and intimate C. a universal D. an absence	A	Conjunction can arise and cease.
26	"Air is not fire" exemplifies: A. atyantabhava B. anyonyabhava C. pragabhava D. pradhvamsabhava	B	It denies identity between substances.
27	Samanyalaksana is controversial because it claims: A. words are perceived B. God is directly seen C. universals mediate perception beyond a sensed individual D. all memory is false	C	It stretches perception toward class-wide awareness.
28	Which is not a Nyaya cause-type? A. samavayi B. asamavayi C. nimitta D. upadana as a separate fourth cause	D	Material cause is handled under samavayi.
29	The strongest Carvaka objection to inference targets: A. knowledge of vyapti B. existence of senses C. linguistic convention D. self-consciousness	A	Finite observation cannot trivially establish universal concomitance.
30	Visesa stops regress by being: A. a universal B. self-differentiating C. a quality of compounds D. perceptible colour	B	It is treated as primitive thisness.
31	Yoga's Isvara differs from Nyaya's God because Yoga stresses: A. material creation B. Vedic authorship C. special purusa and meditative aid D. atom arrangement only	C	Its primary function is soteriological.
32	Best overall verdict: A. Nyaya is only formal logic B. Vaisesika denies external reality C. samavaya is ordinary conjunction D. the synthesis is rigorous realism, though primitive relations and theism remain contested	D	This captures both achievement and pressure points.

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Why does Nyaya-Vaisesika require both samavaya and samyoga?

Model solution

Samyoga explains contingent contact between independently existing substances; samavaya explains constitutive unity where one relatum cannot exist independently in the relevant manner. A book rests on a table by conjunction, while colour inheres in the table, a whole inheres in parts, and a universal inheres in instances.

Reducing inference to conjunction would make qualities and wholes detachable substances. Reducing conjunction to inference would make every accidental contact eternal. The distinction therefore protects both ontological dependence and change.

Verdict: The pair is systematic, though samavaya invites regress because an unexplained primitive relation is used to explain relatedness.

Why this earns marks: It uses exact examples, shows why neither relation can replace the other, and includes the core criticism.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Is Nyaya's theory of pramana best understood as realism disciplined by fallibilism?

Model solution

Nyaya is realist because cognition discloses mind-independent objects and truth consists in presenting an object as it is. Perception, inference, comparison and testimony are objective routes to prama.

It is disciplined because not every cognition is valid. Doubt, error and memory are separated from fresh true cognition; inference requires five hetu-marks; testimony requires apta; perception excludes error and doubt. Validity is generally established extrinsically through successful activity and absence of defeaters.

This produces a fallibilist structure: human cognitions can be tested, corrected and defeated. Yet Nyaya sometimes overextends realism through extraordinary perception, real universals and ontological absences.

Verdict: Nyaya is not naive realism. Its strength lies in coupling external objects with elaborate error-diagnostics, though some metaphysical commitments exceed what those diagnostics establish.

Why this earns marks: It interprets the whole epistemology rather than listing pramanas and gives a balanced thesis-driven answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: "Nyaya-Vaisesika achieves systematic completeness by multiplying primitive entities." Critically examine.

Model solution

The system's achievement is remarkable. Seven padarthas classify positive and negative reality; four pramanas explain knowledge; anyathakhyati preserves realism about error; atman secures continuity; Isvara and adrstā coordinate moral-cosmic order; arambhavada and atoms explain production.

Completeness, however, relies on primitives. Samavaya is a self-linking relation introduced to stop regress. Visesa is self-differentiating particularity introduced to individuate otherwise identical eternals. Universals are objective entities; absences are real; atomic manas coordinates cognition; God directs atoms and karma.

The defender replies that every ontology ends with primitives. The relevant test is explanatory economy, not elimination of basic entities. Samavaya unifies several dependence-relations, visesa secures plurality, and abhava explains determinate negative judgement.

Critics answer that a single label may redescribe rather than explain a problem. Buddhist process theory avoids enduring substances; Mimamsa avoids divine authorship; nominalist approaches avoid universals. Nyaya's response is abductive: its package best preserves common-sense realism, inference, language, identity and responsibility together.

Verdict: The charge is partly justified. Nyaya-Vaisesika's primitives make it systematic, but their value depends on whether unified explanatory coverage outweighs ontological cost. Its greatest strength and weakness are the same—refusal to leave any cognitive or worldly distinction without a realist correlate.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates the system as a whole, names the principal primitives, gives the realist defence, compares rival economies, and reaches a graded verdict.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES - NYAYA-VAISESIKA

System Spine

PADARTHA → mind-independent reality
PRAMANA → valid cognition of reality
ATMAN → enduring owner of cognition and action
ISVARA → intelligent coordinator of atoms and karma
APAVARGA → removal of error and suffering

Seven Categories

- Dravya: nine substances.
- Guna: twenty-four dependent qualities.
- Karma: five physical motions.
- Samanya: real universal, one in many.
- Visesa: primitive thisness of eternal simples.
- Samavaya: inherence between inseparable relata.
- Abhava: determinate absence with locus and counterpositive.

Relation Grid

Relation	Relata	Status	Example
Samyoga	separable substances	produced/destructible	book on table
Samavaya	dependent and locus	eternal/sui generis	brownness in table

Four Pramanas

- Perception: sense-object contact; non-verbal, non-errant, determinate.
- Inference: hetu plus vyapti applied through paramarsa.
- Comparison: word-object relation learned through similarity.
- Testimony: meaningful statement of apta.

Perception

- Ordinary: external and internal.
- Extraordinary: samanyalaksana, jñanalaksana, yogaja.
- Nirvikalpaka: indeterminate.
- Savikalpaka: qualified and relational.
- Strong core: ordinary object-perception.
- Weak extension: universal-mediated and yogic perception.

Inference

pratijna → hetu → udaharana → upanaya → nigamana

- Five hetu marks: pakṣadharmata, sapakṣasattva, vipakṣa-absence, abadhitatva, asatpratipakṣatva.
- Five fallacies: savyabhicāra, viruddha, satpratipakṣa, asiddha, badhita.
- Vyapti tools: repeated observation, no deviation, upadhi-removal, tarka.

Error

- Anyathakhyati: real property remembered elsewhere is mislocated here.
- Jñanalaksana makes the absent property perceptually present.
- Strength: preserves realism.
- Pressure: extraordinary contact may be ad hoc.

Self and Liberation

- Atman is enduring substance of cognition, desire, aversion, effort, pleasure and pain.

- Arguments: memory, recognition, desire, cross-sensory unity, agency, possessive awareness.
- Manas is atomic internal sense.
- Apavarga is cessation of suffering, embodiment and mental qualities.
- Objection: liberated self appears stone-like.

God

- Efficient, not material, cause.
- Karyat: world-effect.
- Ayojanat: atomic arrangement.
- Dhrtiyadeh: support/order.
- Sruteh and pratyayatah: scripture and authority.
- Best read cumulatively.
- Pressure: karma does not fully remove problem of evil.

Causation and Atomism

- Asatkaryavada/arambhavada: effect is new.
- Causes: samavayi, asamavayi, nimitta.
- Cause must be ananyathasiddha antecedent.
- Pragabhava ends at production.
- Eternal partless atoms combine into dyads and larger bodies.
- God and adrsta initiate and guide motion.

PYQ Route Map

- 2018: relations, absence, comparative theism.
- 2019: abhava, error-perception, Udayana.
- 2020: causal relevance, visesa.
- 2021: seed-tree, testimony, samavaya definition.
- 2022: samanya, defence of inference.
- 2023: negation, perception, fallacies, pragabhava.
- 2024: self proofs, two kinds of absence.
- 2025: pramana-result, causation, Gautama's perception.

Final Traps

1. Samavaya is not conjunction.
2. Abhava is relational, not featureless nothing.
3. Consciousness is a quality of self, not its essence.
4. Memory is not fresh prama.
5. Tarka assists inference but is not an independent pramana.
6. Samanyalaksana is extraordinary perception.
7. Anyathakhyati mislocates a real property.
8. Nyaya God is efficient cause; atoms are material causes.
9. Asatkaryavada does not mean production from absolute nothing.
10. Visesa applies to eternal simples, not ordinary compounds.